

English

Year 2

Student Manual



PRIME BOOKS

The Story Workshop

English · Year 2 · Student Book

Written and made at Prime School, Portugal, for pupils aged 6–7



The Story Workshop

The Story Workshop: English, Year 2, Student Book

First edition, published 2026.

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Original content. Every story, poem, playscript, information text, exercise and illustration in this book was made for it. The stories *The Wonky Kite*, *Soup for Everybody*, *The Umbrella on the Wall*, *The Gull and the Lighthouse Keeper*, *The Night Rui Would Not Sleep* and *The Jar of Stars*, and the poems in Units 3, 7 and 8, are original works and are copyright Prime School 2026. The characters Ines, Tomas, Aisha, Beto and Rui are inventions; any resemblance to a particular pupil is coincidental.

Facts and figures. Every factual claim in the non-fiction units was checked against a named published source at the time of writing, and those sources are listed on the Where the facts came from page at the back. Figures that change, such as animal population estimates and sports results, are dated where they appear.

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Web addresses. The QR codes in this book point to sites that were checked and reachable when it went to print. Prime School is not responsible for the content of sites it does not own, and a teacher should always look at a destination before sending a class to it.

This book is meant to be written in. The writing lines, boxes and frames are part of the teaching and are sized for a Year 2 hand.

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Every unit has the same nine parts, and page 6 shows you what each one looks like. You will meet all of them in Unit 1.



WELCOME

This is a workshop, not a book of tests

A workshop is a place where things get made. In this one the things you make are sentences, stories, poems, reports and plays. They are made out of words, and words can be picked up, moved about, taken apart and put back together, just like anything else on a bench.

You will meet four pupils in these pages. **Ines** notices things and writes them on slips of paper. **Tomas** always tries something first, so you can see how it goes before you try it yourself. **Aisha** asks the awkward question, which is usually the useful one. **Beto** wants to make something out of everything, and the end of each unit is where he gets his way.

● INES FOUND THIS OUT

Words are older than writing. People were telling stories out loud for thousands of years before anybody thought of putting them down on anything, which is why a story still works better when you read it aloud.

There are nine units. Each one begins with something to read, because reading is what the rest of it is for. Then you find out how that piece of writing was built, and then you build one yourself.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Three things to know before you start.

Write in this book. The lines and boxes are for you. A crossing-out is not a mistake, it is a writer changing their mind, which is what writers do most.

Say it before you write it. Almost every task in this book works better if you say your sentence out loud to somebody first. You will hear the bit that does not work.

Nothing here is finished on the first go. Not the stories in this book either. *The Wonky Kite* on page 2 was written four times before it went in.

The nine parts of every unit

Every unit is built the same way, so once you know these you know your way round all nine. Here they are, small, with what each one is for.

OPEN THE WORKSHOP

Where a unit begins. It tells you what the unit is about and what you already know that will help.

● WHAT HAPPENED AT PRIME SCHOOL

Something that really happened in our classroom.

A short true story about the four pupils, which is the thing the unit then teaches you to do.

✓ BY THE END OF THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- what you will be able to do by the end
- written as things you can do, not topics you will cover

WARM UP YOUR WORDS

A quick word game to get your mouth and your brain going. Two minutes, no writing.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

A question about something you learnt earlier, because nothing in English gets used only once.

The reading itself

THIS IS WHAT A READING PAGE LOOKS LIKE

Every unit opens with something to read: a story, a play, a poem or a true information text, written for this book. Everything else in the unit is taught out of it.

■ LEARN: THE PART WITH THE RULE IN IT

The teaching. When there is a rule to know, it is printed like this:

A **sentence** begins with a capital letter and ends with a full stop, a question mark or an exclamation mark.

The kite flew. Did the kite fly? What a kite!

■ WATCH TOMAS TRY IT

How does Tomas work out where a full stop goes?

- 1 He reads the words aloud and listens for where his voice drops.
- 2 He puts a full stop there with his pencil.
- 3 He reads it again from the start to check it still makes sense.

We found out: reading aloud tells you where a sentence ends, because your voice does it for you.

1 Practise. Numbered jobs for you to do, with room to do them in.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

How do you know? You will see this a lot. Saying how you worked something out is worth as much as getting it right.

● INES FOUND THIS OUT

Something Ines noticed and wrote on a slip of paper. True, and usually surprising.

➔ GO FURTHER

Go further. For when you have finished and want more.

★ BETO'S CHALLENGE

Beto's challenge. Harder, and always makes something.

■ WHAT YOU NEED

a pencil, this book, and somebody to read your sentence to

● WORK TOGETHER

Work together. Two pupils, or a small group.

ALONG THE WAY

★ MAKE SOMETHING WITH IT

Make something with it. The end of the unit, where everything you have learnt goes into one real thing: a book, a poster, a play, a report.

□ CHECK WHAT YOU CAN DO

- 1 Check what you can do. Different questions from the practice ones, so it tells you something new.

	confident	almost there	needs more work
How did you get on? You tick the honest box.	☐	☐	☐

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK · CONTINUED

- ✓ Look what you can do now. The list of what changed.

WORDS FROM THIS UNIT



words

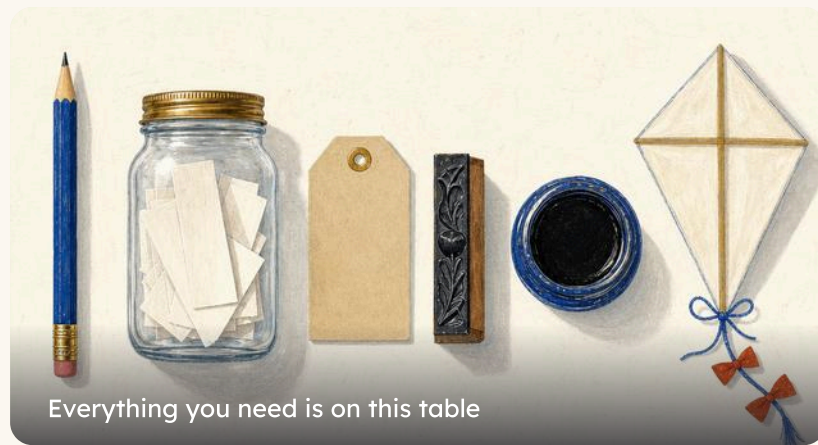
the ones from this unit



Look a word up properly

for teachers, and for pupils with an adult

The brown paper tag beside a writing frame means your teacher may photocopy that page, so you can do it more than once.



GETTING SET UP

What you need, and how the workshop runs

■ WHAT YOU NEED

a pencil you like writing with, a rubber, this book, a notebook for your own word slips, and a folder to keep your finished work in

■ FOUR HABITS OF THIS WORKSHOP

- 1 Read it out loud first.** Every piece of writing in this book was read aloud before it was printed. Yours should be too.
- 2 Keep your own word slips.** When you meet a word you like, write it on a slip and keep it. Unit 8 asks you to use them.
- 3 Say what you notice.** Not just the answer: what you noticed on the way to it.
- 4 Finish, then improve.** Get to the end first. Then go back and make one thing better.

START YOUR WORD JAR TODAY

Your **word slips** are the one thing in this book you build up over the whole year. Cut a page of paper into strips the size of a plaster. One word on each, big enough to read across a table. Keep them in a jar or an envelope.

By Unit 8 you will have a hundred of them, and that is the unit where you spread them all out and build a story from the ones you pick up.

■ FOR TEACHERS

This book assumes four to five hours of English a week, which is roughly a unit every three and a half weeks across a 34-week year, with time left over for reading for pleasure.

Each unit is built to be taught in order: the reading text comes first because every skill afterwards is taught out of it. The practice pages can be split across lessons, and the project is designed to run over two or three.

Pupils need the word slips from the first week. They are the book's one piece of continuous apparatus, and Units 3, 5 and 8 all depend on a jar that has been filling up since September.

Answers are not printed. Where a task has one right answer the modelled attempt shows how it is reached, and the reasoning prompts are meant to be talked through rather than marked.



Prime School

for teachers and families

primeschool.pt



UNIT ONE

Games we play

A story about a kite that would not fly, and how two people made it fly. Then you make something too.

OPEN THE WORKSHOP

This unit begins with a story called **The Wonky Kite**. It was written for this book. Read it once to find out what happens, then read it again more slowly, because the second time is when you start noticing things.

You already know how to read a story and say what happened in it. In this unit you will learn to say **how** it was built.

 BY THE END OF THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- read a story and retell the main events in the right order
- say what a character is like, using what they do as your evidence
- write what somebody says, with speech marks and a new line for each speaker
- make compound words, and break long words into syllables
- use adjectives that earn their place
- write and illustrate a story of your own in six pictures

 **WARM UP
YOUR
WORDS**

Say your own name, then a game you like, then a word that rhymes with the game. Round the class, no repeats. If you get stuck, say a word that starts the same way instead.

**Find the next story to share**

for teachers and families, to choose a book

booktrust.org.uk, Bookfinder

The Wonky Kite

AN ORIGINAL STORY · PRIME BOOKS · PART ONE

1 Beto wanted a kite more than anything. He did not want one from a shop. He wanted one he had made, so on Saturday morning he spread brown paper over the kitchen table and got to work.

2 He cut two sticks from the garden. He glued the paper over them. He tied on a long string. By lunchtime it was done, and he held it up to show his sister.

3 “It is a bit wonky,” said Ines.

“It is not wonky,” said Beto. “It is a kite.”

One side was longer than the other. Beto could see it. He did not want to see it.

4 Up on the hill the wind was strong. Beto ran and ran with the string over his shoulder. The kite lifted, swung hard to the left, and dived straight into the grass. He tried again. It dived again.

5 The fourth time, it flew into a hawthorn tree and stuck there. Beto sat down on the grass and did not say anything at all for a long time.



Beto begins, and will not be told anything



"It is not wonky. It is a kite."

DO YOU REMEMBER?

Stop here, before you turn over. Write one sentence saying what you think Beto will do next.

Then turn over and find out. The story carries on.

The Wonky Kite

PART TWO

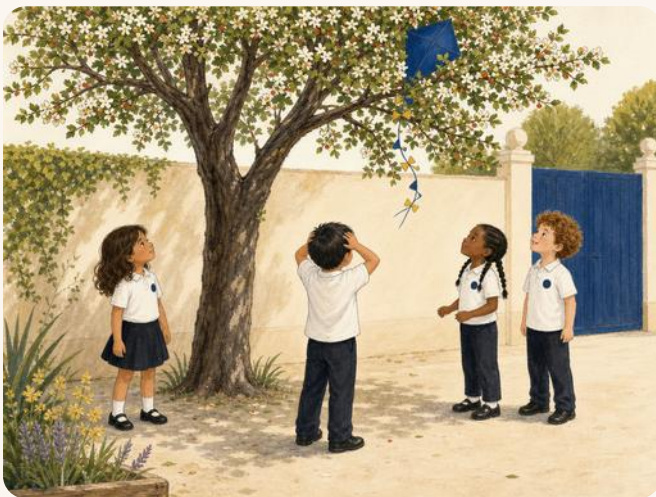
Then Ines climbed up and got it down. She looked at the two sticks. She looked at the long side and the short side. “It needs a tail,” she said.

They made one out of folded paper triangles, all along a piece of string, and tied it to the bottom of the kite. Beto thought it looked silly.

It flew. It went up and up, past the hawthorn tree, past the top of the hill, until it was a small brown mark in a big blue sky, and the string was tight and singing in their hands.

“It is still wonky,” said Ines.

“I know,” said Beto. “It flies though.”



Stuck in the hawthorn, and nothing to say



A small brown mark in a big blue sky

DO YOU REMEMBER?

Look back at the sentence you wrote before you turned over. Were you right? Write down what you got right.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

Beto knew one side was longer. The story says so. Why do you think he said it was not?

Talking about the story**THE WORD THIS WHOLE BOOK USES MOST**

A **sentence** is a group of words that makes sense on its own. It begins with a **capital letter** and ends with a **full stop**, a **question mark** or an exclamation mark.

A **poem** is writing set out in short lines, often with a pattern of sound in it. A **verse** is one block of lines in a poem, with a gap before the next one.

The kite flew. Did the kite fly? What a kite!

WATCH TOMAS TRY 1

Aisha says Beto is stubborn. How can Tomas tell whether she is right?

- 1** He looks for something Beto **does**, not something the story says about him. The story never uses the word stubborn.
- 2** He finds it in paragraph 3: Beto can see the kite is wonky and he does not want to see it.
- 3** He finds another one: Beto tries four times without changing anything about the kite.
- 4** Two pieces of evidence is enough to say it out loud.

We found out: you can show what a character is like by pointing at what they do. Aisha is right, and paragraph 3 is the proof.

- 1** Who made the kite? Who made it fly? Answer in one sentence each.

- 2** Beto tried four times before Ines helped. Find the paragraph that tells you, and write its number.

- 3 Put these five events in order, from first to last. Number them 1 to 5.

The kite stuck in the tree. Beto cut two sticks. They tied on a paper tail.
The kite flew high. Ines said it was wonky.

- 4 What sort of person is Ines? Give one thing she does as your evidence.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

Ines says the kite is still wonky right at the end, when it is flying beautifully. Why do you think she says that?

The shape of the story

■ EVERY STORY HAS THREE PARTS

A story is not just one thing after another. It has a shape, and once you can see the shape you can build one yourself.

A **story** has a **beginning**, where you find out who it is about and what they want; a **middle**, where something goes wrong; and an **end**, where it is put right or changed. The place a story happens is its **setting**. The people in it are its **characters**.

BEGINNING

Beto wants a kite he has made himself, and he makes one.

MIDDLE

It will not fly, and he will not admit why.

END

Ines sees what is wrong. They add a tail. It flies.

5 Where is the setting of this story? Name both places.

6 The middle of the story is the longest part. Why do you think that is?

7 Fill in this story map for a story you know well.

BEGINNING**MIDDLE****END****● INES FOUND THIS OUT**

The oldest kites we know about were flown in China more than two thousand years ago, and they were made of silk and bamboo because paper had not been invented yet.



Sorting out who said what

1.2

Writing what people say

● WHAT HAPPENED AT PRIME SCHOOL

Tomas wrote a whole page with no speech marks in it and nobody could tell who was talking.

He read it out and it made sense, because he knew who said what. Then Aisha read it out and got it wrong twice. That is what speech marks are for: they are not decoration, they tell a reader where a voice starts and stops.

■ SPEECH MARKS, AND A NEW LINE FOR EACH SPEAKER

Speech marks go around the exact words somebody says, and nothing else. When a different person speaks, you start a **new line**.

A **comma** is the small mark that separates one part of a sentence from another. In speech it goes inside the speech marks, just before the closing one.

“It is a bit wonky,” said Ines.

The speech marks hold only the words that came out of her mouth. The words said Ines are outside them, because nobody said those. The comma goes inside.

Ines “It is a bit wonky.”

Beto “It is not wonky. It is a kite.”

Beto does not look at the kite while he says it.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

Look at the line above. How can you tell that Beto did not say the words *said Beto*?

WATCH TOMAS TRY 2

How does Tomas put speech marks into this line? *I know said Beto it flies though*

- 1 He reads it aloud and works out which words came out of Beto's mouth: *I know* and *it flies though*.
- 2 He puts speech marks around the first part and a comma before the closing mark: **“I know,” said Beto.**
- 3 The second part is a new sentence Beto says, so it gets its own speech marks and its own capital letter.
- 4 He checks: everything inside the marks is something Beto really said.

We found out: “I know,” said Beto. “It flies though.” Two sentences, both his, both inside marks.

8 Copy these lines and put in the missing speech marks.

It needs a tail, she said. I am not climbing that tree, said Beto.
Look at it now, said Ines.

9 Write what Beto said when the kite went into the tree. Use speech marks.

10 Write four lines of talk between Beto and Ines while they make the tail. Give each speaker a new line.

YOUR DIALOGUE

 WORK TOGETHER

Work in pairs. One of you is Beto, one is Ines. Read your four lines out loud to each other, then swap parts and read them again. Change one line that sounded wrong.

 WHAT YOU NEED

your four lines, and a partner



1.3

Words made of other words

COMPOUND WORDS

A **compound word** is one word made by joining two whole words together. Both words keep their own spelling, and the new word usually means something you can guess from the two parts.

play + ground = playground

foot + ball = football

hawthorn = haw + thorn

11 Join one word from each side to make four compound words.

after

shine

sun

noon

week

side

sea

end

12 Write two compound words you can find in the story.

BREAKING A LONG WORD UP

A **syllable** is a beat in a word. Clap as you say a word and you will hear them. Breaking a long word into syllables is how you read it and how you spell it.

kite

kite

1 clap

wonky

won

ky

2 claps

hawthorn

haw

thorn

2 claps

triangle

tri

an

gle

3 claps

13 Clap these words and write how many syllables each one has.

garden Saturday string

beautiful

14 Sort these words into the right tray by how many beats they have.

paper hill lunchtime sister grass singing

One beat

Two beats

Three beats

➔ GO FURTHER

Find the longest word in **The Wonky Kite**. Clap it. Write it down broken into its syllables with a dash between each one.

THE WORD I FOUND HARD

HOW I WILL REMEMBER IT

● INES FOUND THIS OUT

The word kite is the name of a bird. The bird got the name first, and people gave it to the flying toy afterwards, because a red kite hangs almost still in the wind in exactly the same way.



1.4

Words that describe

ADJECTIVES

A **noun** is a naming word: *kite, sister, hill*. An **adjective** is a word that tells you more about a noun: *a wonky kite, a strong wind*. An adjective earns its place only if it tells the reader something they did not already know.

kite

wonky

brown

home-made

WATCH TOMAS TRY 3

Tomas has written *the nice kite*. Can he do better?

- 1** He asks what *nice* tells a reader. Almost nothing: everything can be nice.
- 2** He looks at the picture again and writes down three things he can actually see: brown paper, two sticks, a long tail.
- 3** He picks the one a reader could not guess: *the paper-tailed kite*.

We found out: an adjective that could go in front of anything is doing no work. Say what you can see instead.

- 15** Write two adjectives for each of these nouns. Do not use *nice*, *good* or *lovely*.

Noun	Adjective	Adjective
wind		
tree		
string		
sky		

- 16** Choose the better sentence and draw a ring round it. Then say why.

Beto made a nice kite.

Beto made a lopsided brown kite.

A poem to read aloud

The Wind's Hand

The wind is a hand I cannot see.

It lifts my kite away from me,
It pulls the string and holds it tight,
It carries all my paper flight.

I cannot hold it, cannot look,

I only feel it, like a hook.

And when it drops and lets me go,

My kite comes down to earth. And so
I wind the string and wait, and then
The wind puts out its hand again.

a

a

b

b

c

c

d

d

e

e

An original poem for this book

The letters down the side show which lines rhyme. Lines with the same letter end with the same sound.

17 Read the poem out loud twice. Which two words rhyme in the first pair?

18 The poem calls the wind a hand. Find two things the hand does in the poem.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

You learnt about syllables on page 5. Clap the first line of the poem. How many beats?

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

The poem never says the word *wind* after the first line. How do you know it is still talking about it?



Poems read by the poets themselves

for teachers, to play in the classroom

childrens.poetryarchive.org

EVERYTHING IN THIS UNIT

★ MAKE A SIX-PICTURE STORY

Make a **six-picture story** of your own about a game that went wrong and then went right. It can be true or invented. When it is finished you will read it to the class.

- 1 Plan it on a story map first: beginning, middle, end. The middle is where it goes wrong.
- 2 Draw your six pictures in the boxes on the next page. Pictures first, words second: that is how **The Wonky Kite** was made.
- 3 Write one or two sentences under each picture. Use a capital letter and a full stop in every one.
- 4 Put in at least two lines of talk, with speech marks and a new line for each speaker.
- 5 Use three adjectives that a reader could not have guessed.
- 6 Read it out loud to a partner. Change one thing that sounded wrong. Then read it to the class.

■ WHAT YOU NEED

this book, a pencil, coloured pencils, and a partner to read to

● WORK TOGETHER

Swap books with a partner when you have both finished. Read their story out loud to them. Tell them one thing that worked and ask them one question about the middle.

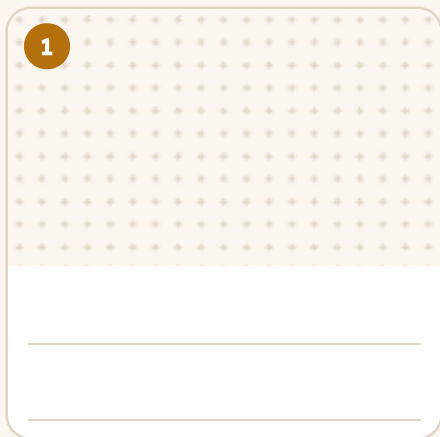
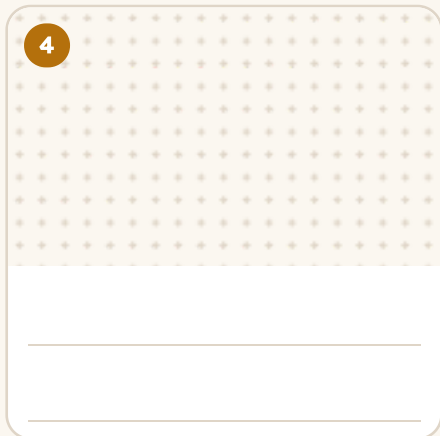
★ BETO'S CHALLENGE

Write your story a second time as if the other character were telling it. Nothing that happens changes. Only who is speaking changes, and you will find that almost every sentence has to change too.

FINAL PROJECT

Your six-picture story

Draw in the boxes. Write on the lines. The brown paper tag means your teacher may photocopy this page.

1 	2 	3 
4 	5 	6 

■ WHAT YOU NEED

a pencil, coloured pencils, and your story map

END OF UNIT 1

What you can do now

□ CHECK WHAT YOU CAN DO

- 1 Write one sentence saying where **The Wonky Kite** happens.
- 2 Turn this into speech: *Ines told Beto the kite needed a tail.*
- 3 Make a compound word using the word *day*.
- 4 Clap *Saturday* and write the number of beats.
- 5 Write an adjective for *hill* that is not *big*.
- 6 Name the three parts every story has.

	confident	almost there	needs more work
I can retell a story in the right order	☐	☐	☐
I can say what a character is like and give my evidence	☐	☐	☐
I can use speech marks and a new line for each speaker	☐	☐	☐
I can make compound words and clap syllables	☐	☐	☐
I can choose adjectives that do some work	☐	☐	☐

- ✓ You can read a story and say what happened, in order.
- ✓ You can point at what a character does to show what they are like.
- ✓ You can write down what people say so a reader knows who is talking.
- ✓ You can build compound words and break long words into beats.
- ✓ You have written and illustrated a story of your own.

WORDS FROM THIS UNIT**kite**

a light frame covered in paper, flown on a string

**string**

thin cord you tie or pull with

**wind**

air moving from one place to another

**playground**

an outdoor place made for playing

**football**

a ball game played with the feet

**juggle**

to keep several things in the air at once

**adjective**

a word that tells you more about a noun

**speech marks**

the marks that hold the exact words somebody says

■ FOR TEACHERS

This unit carries objectives 2Ri.02, 2Ri.03, 2Ri.07, 2Ri.08, 2Rs.01, 2Ra.01, 2Ra.03, 2Rw.06, 2Rv.02, 2Rv.03, 2Rv.04, 2Rg.01, 2Rg.05, 2Wg.03, 2Wg.10, 2Wv.02, 2Ws.01, 2Wc.01, 2Wc.02, 2Wp.04, 2Ww.10, 2SLm.01, 2SLp.01, 2SLp.02, 2SLp.03, 2SLp.04, 2SLg.01 and 2SLr.01.

The story is printed in two parts on purpose. Stopping at the hawthorn tree lets pupils predict before they read on, and Unit 8 returns to prediction with a text they judge from its covers alone.

Pupils who write *nice* and *good* are not being lazy: those words are genuinely the most available ones. The spotlight component works because it makes them try three and choose, rather than telling them a rule about weak adjectives.

Misconceptions this unit tackles head on: that speech marks go round the whole line including *said* *Ines*, and that a longer adjective is automatically a better one.



UNIT TWO

Faster, higher, braver

True writing about real people. How to find a fact, how to check it, and how to write it up so somebody believes you.

OPEN THE WORKSHOP

Everything you read in Unit 1 was invented. This unit is the opposite: every word of the long text on the next two pages is true, and at the back of this book you can see exactly where each fact came from.

Writing that is true has a different job from writing that is invented, so it is built differently. In this unit you find out how, and then you write some.

✓ BY THE END OF THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- tell a fiction book from a non-fiction book, and say how you knew
- skim a text quickly to find one fact
- read a poster and a table and answer questions from them
- use a comma to separate things in a list
- write a short newspaper report from facts you have found

■ TWO KINDS OF BOOK

Fiction is writing somebody made up. **Non-fiction** is writing about things that really happened or really exist. Both can be brilliant. Only one of them has to be true.

A story

FOR enjoying what somebody imagined

LOOK FOR characters, a setting, something going wrong and being put right

YOU MEET IT story books, comics, films

An information text

FOR finding out about something real

LOOK FOR a title, subheadings, real numbers, photographs with captions

YOU MEET IT school books, museum signs, websites

1 Sort these into the right tray.

The Wonky Kite a book about volcanoes a bus timetable
a story about a talking dog a football results table

Fiction

Non-fiction

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

You have never read *a book about volcanoes*. So how do you know which tray it goes in?

The Games that started in a hospital

INFORMATION TEXT · FIGURES CORRECT FOR THE PARIS 2024 GAMES

1 The Paralympic Games are the biggest sports competition in the world for athletes with a disability. They are held every four years, in the same year and usually in the same city as the Olympic Games, and they follow a few weeks afterwards.

2 They began in a hospital. In 1948, a doctor called Ludwig Guttman organised an archery competition for sixteen injured soldiers at Stoke Mandeville Hospital in England, on the same day the London Olympic Games opened. Twelve years later, in 1960, the first proper Paralympic Games were held in Rome, with four hundred athletes from twenty-three countries.

3 The Games have grown enormously since then. At the Paris Paralympic Games in 2024 there were more than four thousand athletes from about one hundred and sixty-eight countries, competing in twenty-two different sports.

The Games that started in a hospital *continued*

Some Paralympic sports are ones you already know, played a little differently. Others exist nowhere else. In **goalball** every player wears a blindfold and the ball has bells inside it, so the whole hall must stay completely silent while the game is played. In **boccia** players roll leather balls as close as they can to a white target ball, and a player who cannot throw may use a ramp.

The Paralympic symbol is three curved shapes called the Agitos, in red, blue and green. Agito is a Latin word and it means *I move*. The three shapes are arranged in a circle round a centre point, because the Games bring athletes together from every part of the world.



Non-fiction is full of photographs of real people



A medal is a fact you can hold



Real results, kept up to date

for teachers, to plan the report-writing lesson

paralympic.org

2.2

Finding a fact fast

● WHAT HAPPENED AT PRIME SCHOOL

Aisha found the year 1960 in four seconds and could not explain how.

She had not read the text again. She had run her eye down it looking only for something with digits in it. That is called **skimming**, and it is a different skill from reading.

■ SKIMMING

When you **skim**, you do not read every word. You decide first what shape the answer has, then look only for that shape. A year is digits. A country starts with a capital letter. A sport is usually in bold.

WATCH TOMAS TRY 4

How does Tomas find out how many countries came in 1960, in under ten seconds?

- 1 He works out the shape of the answer first: it is a number.
- 2 He looks for the paragraph about 1960, which is paragraph 2.
- 3 He runs his eye along that paragraph only, looking for digits or number words.
- 4 He finds *twenty-three countries* and stops. He does not read the rest.

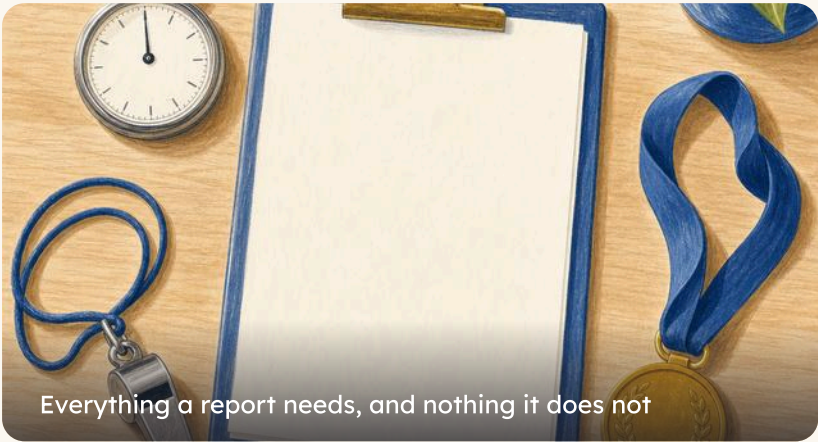
We found out: twenty-three countries came in 1960, and finding it took one paragraph, not five.

- 2 Skim the text to answer these. Write the paragraph number beside each answer.

Question	Answer	Paragraph
In which year were the first Paralympic Games?		
In which city were they held?		
How many athletes came to Paris in 2024?		
How many sports were there in Paris?		
What does the word Agito mean?		

3 Which sport is played in silence? Write one sentence saying why it has to be.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?
How did you decide which paragraph to look in first?



Reading a table

A table puts facts in rows and columns so you can compare them without reading any sentences at all.

Games	Year	Athletes	Countries
Rome	1960	400	23
Seoul	1988	3 057	60
Sydney	2000	3 881	122
London	2012	4 237	164
Paris	2024	4 400	168

Athlete and country numbers as published by the International Paralympic Committee. See page 114.

4 Which Games had the most countries? Which had the fewest?

5 How many more countries came to Paris than to Rome? Show your working.

6 Put these four Games in order, from fewest athletes to most athletes.

Sydney Rome London Seoul

INES FOUND THIS OUT

At the very first Games in Rome in 1960, the athletes stayed in a building with no lift, so Italian soldiers carried every wheelchair up and down the stairs by hand, four flights, several times a day.

→ GO FURTHER

Look at the table again. Between which two Games did the number of countries grow the most? Write it as a sentence with both years in it.

2.3

Commas in a list

■ THE COMMA

A **list** is three or more things written one after another in a sentence. You put a **comma** between them, and the word *and* before the last one. A comma separates. It never ends a sentence: that is the full stop's job.

The Agitos are red, blue and green.

There are athletes from Portugal, Brazil, Kenya **and** Japan.

Three commas would be wrong here. You need one between each pair, and then *and* does the last join instead of a comma.

7 Copy these and put the commas in.

I packed a whistle a stopwatch and a clipboard.

We play football goalball boccia and tennis.

The medal is brass gold and heavy.

2.3 · CONTINUED

8 Write a list sentence of four sports you would like to try.

9 One sentence below has a comma too many. Draw a ring round the comma that should not be there.

We watched the swimming, the running and the throwing.

We watched the swimming, the running, and the throwing.

10 Write a list sentence naming four countries from the table on page 17.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 1 you learnt where a full stop goes. Read your list sentence aloud. Where does your voice drop?

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

How do you know that the last join needs *and* and not a fourth comma?



2.4

Writing a report

■ WHAT A REPORT DOES

A **report** tells a reader what happened, as plainly and truthfully as possible. It starts with the most important thing, not with the beginning. It says **who**, **what**, **where** and **when**, and it does not say what the writer felt about it.

WATCH TOMAS TRY 5

Beto starts his report *It was a really amazing day and I loved it.* **Why does Tomas change it?**

- 1** He asks the four questions: who, what, where, when. Beto's sentence answers none of them.
- 2** He also spots two words about how Beto felt, which belong in a story, not a report.
- 3** He rewrites it with the facts first: **On Friday morning Year 2 held a sports afternoon on the school field.**
- 4** He checks it: who is Year 2, what is a sports afternoon, where is the field, when is Friday morning. All four.

We found out: a report opens with the four facts, and a reader who reads only the first sentence still knows what happened.

- 11** Underline the four facts in Tomas's first sentence above.
 - 12** Rewrite this for a report: *The race was brilliant and everyone went wild.*
-
-

13 Write the first sentence of a report about your school this week.

 WORK TOGETHER

Work in threes. One of you says a sentence about something that happened at school. The other two check it for who, what, where and when, and say which one is missing.

 WHAT YOU NEED

a pencil, and two other pupils

EVERYTHING IN THIS UNIT

★ MAKE A FRONT PAGE

Write and lay out a **front-page newspaper report** about a real sports event at your school. If there has not been one, report on a lesson.

- 1 Find your facts first. Ask somebody who was there. Write the four answers down before you write a single sentence.
- 2 Write a headline. A headline is not a sentence and it does not get a full stop. Keep it under seven words.
- 3 Write your opening sentence with all four facts in it.
- 4 Add two more sentences: one with a list in it, using commas, and one with a real number in it.
- 5 Draw a picture and write a caption underneath it saying who is in it and what they are doing.
- 6 Check every fact one more time. A report with a wrong fact in it is worse than no report.

PRIME SCHOOL NEWS

YOUR HEADLINE

Draw a picture for your
report

■ WHAT YOU NEED

your four facts, a pencil, and this page

★ BETO'S CHALLENGE

Write the same event twice: once as a report and once as a story.
Read both to a partner and ask them which one they believed
more, and why.

END OF UNIT 2

What you can do now

☐ CHECK WHAT YOU CAN DO

- 1 Name one way you can tell a non-fiction book from a story.
- 2 Skim page 15 and write the year the Rome Games were held.
- 3 Put commas in: *We saw archery cycling rowing and swimming.*
- 4 Write the four questions a report answers.
- 5 Say what the word Agito means.
- 6 Write a headline of five words or fewer for the kite story in Unit 1.

	confident	almost there	needs more work
I can tell fiction from non-fiction and say how	☐	☐	☐
I can skim a text to find one fact quickly	☐	☐	☐
I can read a table and compare two rows	☐	☐	☐
I can use commas to separate things in a list	☐	☐	☐
I can write a report that opens with the facts	☐	☐	☐

- ✓ You can find one fact in a long text without reading all of it.
- ✓ You can read a table and say which row is biggest.
- ✓ You can punctuate a list.
- ✓ You have written a real report about something that really happened.

WORDS FROM THIS UNIT

**medal**

a metal disc given for winning something

**stopwatch**

a watch that times exactly how long something takes

**track**

the marked path runners race along

**athlete**

somebody who competes in a sport

**javelin**

a long light spear that is thrown

**hurdle**

a barrier a runner jumps over

**non-fiction**

writing about things that are really true

**comma**

the mark that separates things in a list

■ FOR TEACHERS

This unit carries 2Ri.01, 2Ri.04, 2Ri.05, 2Ri.09, 2Ri.13, 2Ri.14, 2Ri.15, 2Rs.03, 2Rg.05, 2Ra.01, 2Wg.01, 2Wg.02, 2Ws.02, 2Ws.03, 2Wc.04, 2Wc.05, 2Wv.01, 2Wp.04 and 2SLg.03.

The Paralympic Games were chosen over the Olympic Games deliberately. The content is less familiar, so pupils genuinely have to read to answer, and goalball and boccia give the class two genuinely new things rather than a recap of football.

Every figure in the information text and the table is sourced on page 114 and dated in the text. When these Games are superseded, the QR code on page 15 is where the new numbers come from: pupils can update the table themselves, which is a better lesson than a reprint.

Misconception this unit tackles head on: that non-fiction means boring, and that a report is improved by saying how exciting it was.



UNIT THREE

At the long table

A play to act, two poems about food that do not agree with each other, and instructions that only work in the right order.

OPEN THE WORKSHOP

A **playscript** is writing meant to be spoken out loud by different people. You can tell one at a glance, before you read a word of it, because of its shape on the page: a name, then what that person says.

This unit has a play in it, written for this book. You are going to read it, act it, and then find out how it was put together.

✓ BY THE END OF THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- recognise a playscript by its shape and read one aloud in a group
- read two poems on the same subject and say which you prefer, with a reason
- find rhyming words and use the spelling pattern they share
- write instructions in an order that actually works
- design a poster and a programme for a real performance

WARM UP
YOUR
WORDS

Say a food you love. The next person says a food that starts with the last letter of yours. Round the class. No repeats.

■ HOW A PLAYSRIPT IS BUILT

In a **playscript** the speaker's name goes on the left and is not part of what they say, so a play needs **no speech marks at all**. Instructions to the actors are called **stage directions** and are printed differently, because nobody says them out loud.

A playscript

FOR acting out
LOOK FOR a cast list, names down the left, stage directions, no speech marks
YOU MEET IT the theatre, school plays, television

A poem

FOR saying something in as few words as possible
LOOK FOR short lines, verses, often rhyme or repetition
YOU MEET IT poetry books, songs, greetings cards

Soup for Everybody

Four speaking parts: INES, BETO, AISHA, TOMAS. Any number of children who bring one thing each.

A school kitchen. A very large empty pot is on the stove. INES is looking into it.

INES There is nothing in it.

BETO There is water in it.

INES Water is not soup, Beto.

BETO It is the start of soup.

AISHA comes in carrying two carrots.

AISHA I have got two carrots. That is all there was.

INES Two carrots and some water. That is not soup either.

TOMAS It is more soup than it was a minute ago.

TOMAS puts an onion on the table. Everyone looks at it.

BETO Where did you get an onion?

TOMAS Senhora Alves. I said it was for soup and she gave me two.

AISHA Then we have water, two carrots and two onions.

INES It is still not soup.

BETO No. But if everybody who comes in brings one thing, what is it then?

Soup for Everybody *continued*

A long pause. INES looks at the pot. Then she goes to the door and opens it wide.

INES Bring one thing!

Children come in one at a time and put something on the table: a potato, a leek, a handful of beans, a sprig of parsley, a lemon. The table fills up. The pot begins to steam.

AISHA Is it soup yet?

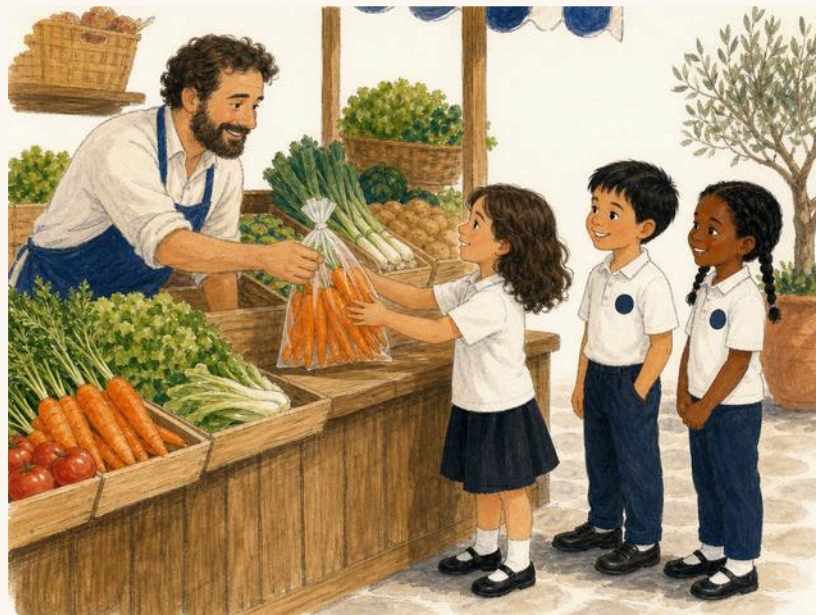
INES Taste it.

AISHA tastes it from a wooden spoon. She says nothing for a moment.

AISHA It is soup.

BETO Whose soup is it?

INES Everybody's. That is the only way it got made.



The long table, before anybody has sat down



Everybody puts one thing in



And then it is everybody's soup

Talking about the play

WATCH TOMAS TRY 6

Aisha says this play has no speech marks by mistake. Is she right?

- 1 Tomas looks at one line: **INES** then **There is nothing in it.**
- 2 He asks what speech marks are for. In Unit 1 he learnt they show where a voice starts and stops.
- 3 In a play the NAME on the left already does that job, so the marks would be doing nothing.
- 4 He checks a printed play from the library. No speech marks there either.

We found out: a playscript needs no speech marks, because the name on the left already tells you who is talking. Aisha was wrong, and checking a real play is how we knew.

1 How many speaking parts does this play have? Where did you look?

2 Find one stage direction and copy it out.

3 Why does Ines open the door wide? Answer in one sentence.

4 Beto asks whose soup it is. Say in your own words what Ines means by her answer.

 WORK TOGETHER

In groups of four, take a part each and read the whole play out loud. Then swap parts and read it again. The second time, try to say your lines as if you really meant them.

 WHAT YOU NEED

four pupils, this book, and a space to stand up in

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

You read it twice. How do you know the second reading was better?

**Hear a script performed**

for teachers, before the playscript lesson

bbc.co.uk/teach/live-lessons

3.2

Two poems, one subject

These two poems are both about soup. They do not agree at all. Neither of them is wrong.

Two words **rhyme** when they end with the same sound. A **verse** is one block of lines in a poem, with a gap before the next one.

Soup: a complaint

Soup is a puddle.
Soup is a lie.
Soup is the thing that they give you when
 you are too poorly for pie.
Soup has no corners.
Soup has no crunch.
Soup is a drink that is pretending
 hard to be a lunch.

a
a
b
b

An original poem for this book

Soup: a defence

a

Soup is the smell before the door.

a

Soup is the steam upon the pane.

b

Soup is what somebody made for you

b

because you had walked home in the rain.

Soup is a spoon and a bowl in both hands.

Soup is the warm going all the way down.

Soup is the kindest thing anyone cooks

in this or in any town.

An original poem for this book

- 5 Which poem do you agree with more? Write one sentence saying why.

- 6 Find two rhyming words in the first poem.

RHYMES AND SPELLINGS

Words that **rhyme** end with the same sound. They often, but not always, share a spelling pattern too. When they do, one word can teach you how to spell the others.

THE AIN LADDER

rain

pain

chain

explain

THE OWN LADDER

town

down

crown

frown

● INES FOUND THIS OUT

Some words rhyme but are spelt completely differently: rain and plane, or town and noun. English is a mixture of several older languages, and that is why.

7 Write two more words that rhyme with *rain* and share its spelling.

8 Sort these into the right tray by their spelling pattern.

gown sprain brown train drown Spain

The ain pattern

The own pattern

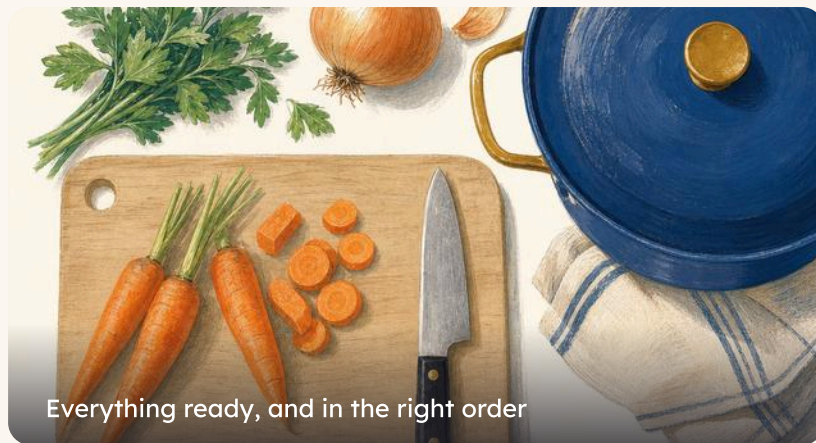
- 9 Find the two rhyming words in the second poem. Write their shared pattern.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 1 you clapped syllables. Clap *explain*. How many beats?

THE WORD I FOUND HARD

HOW I WILL REMEMBER IT



3.3

Instructions that work

COMMANDS

A **command** tells somebody to do something. It starts with the doing word and it does not need to say who: *Chop the onion.* A **statement** tells you something instead: *The onion is chopped.* Instructions are made of commands, and their order matters more than their words.

A**Capital letter**

starts every sentence

Chop the onion.

.

Full stop

ends a statement or a command

*Add the water.***?****Question mark**

ends a question

Is it soup yet?

- 10** Put these instructions in an order that works, from first to last. Number them 1 to 5.

Add the water. Wash the vegetables. Chop the onion.
Let it cook for twenty minutes. Put the pot on the stove.

- 11** Two of those steps cannot be swapped. Which two, and why?

- 12** Write four instructions for making a sandwich. Start each one with the doing word.

YOUR INSTRUCTIONS

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

How do you know your four instructions are in the right order? Test them on somebody.

EVERYTHING IN THIS UNIT

★ PUT ON THE PLAY

Put on **Soup for Everybody** for another class, and make everything a real performance needs.

- 1 Cast it. Four speaking parts and as many bringers as you like. Everybody is in it.
- 2 Rehearse twice. The first time is for the words. The second time is for saying them like you mean them.
- 3 Design a poster. It needs the name of the play, who is in it, where it is and when. Nothing else, in big clear letters.
- 4 Write a programme. List the parts and who plays each one, then write one sentence saying what the play is about.
- 5 Write your own extra scene: one more child arrives with one more thing. Four lines, no speech marks, one stage direction.
- 6 Perform it. Then ask your audience one question about the ending.

■ WHAT YOU NEED

this book, a big sheet of paper for the poster, coloured pencils, and another class to perform to

Your programme

The parts who plays them

Ines

Beto

Aisha

Tomas

What the play is about one sentence

★ BETO'S CHALLENGE

Write your extra scene as a poem instead of a script, keeping the rhyme pattern of one of the soup poems. Then decide which version the audience should get, and be able to say why.

END OF UNIT 3

What you can do now

☐ CHECK WHAT YOU CAN DO

- 1 Name two things you would see in a playscript but never in a story.
- 2 Write a word that rhymes with *chain* and shares its spelling.
- 3 Turn this statement into a command: *The carrots are washed.*
- 4 Which of the two soup poems is a complaint? Give one word as your evidence.
- 5 Write the first two steps for making a cup of tea.
- 6 Why does a playscript not need speech marks?

	confident	almost there	needs more work
I can recognise a playscript and read one aloud in a group	☐	☐	☐
I can compare two poems and give a reason for what I prefer	☐	☐	☐
I can find rhymes and use the spelling pattern they share	☐	☐	☐
I can write instructions in a workable order	☐	☐	☐
I can tell a command from a statement	☐	☐	☐

- ✓ You can read a play aloud with other people and keep your place.
- ✓ You can say which of two poems you prefer, and why.
- ✓ You can use one word's spelling to help you spell three more.
- ✓ You have written instructions somebody else could actually follow.
- ✓ You have performed a play and made the poster for it.

WORDS FROM THIS UNIT**soup**

a hot liquid food made
by cooking things in
water

**carrot**

a long orange root
vegetable

**market**

a place where food and
goods are sold

**spoon**

a tool with a shallow
bowl for eating with

**recipe**

written instructions for
cooking something

**playscript**

writing set out to be
acted, with the speaker's
name on the left

**poem**

writing in short lines,
often with a pattern

**command**

a sentence that tells
somebody to do
something

 FOR TEACHERS

This unit carries 2Ri.02, 2Ri.04, 2Ri.05, 2Ri.06, 2Ri.10, 2Ri.16, 2Rs.01, 2Rg.01, 2Rg.04, 2Ra.01, 2Ra.03, 2Rw.01, 2Ww.01, 2Ww.03, 2Ww.10, 2Wg.04, 2Ws.01, 2Wc.01, 2Wc.04, 2Wp.04, 2SLm.02, 2SLp.01, 2SLp.03, 2SLp.04, 2SLg.01, 2SLr.02 and 2Rv.03.

The play is written so that every child can be in it: four speaking parts and an unlimited number of children who each bring one thing. That is a casting decision, not a literary one, and it is why the script is built round arrivals.

The two soup poems disagree on purpose. A pupil asked which one is right has to notice that preference is not the same as correctness, which is objective 2Ra.03 and is much harder than it looks at six.

Misconception this unit tackles head on: that a playscript is a story with the speech marks left out by accident, and that two poems on one subject must agree.



UNIT FOUR

The kindest thing

A story about something small that somebody did for a stranger. Then verbs, tenses, and a diary of your own to keep.

OPEN THE WORKSHOP

This unit is about small things people do for people they do not know. The story in it was written for this book, and the umbrella in it is real: it belongs to somebody who lent it to us so we could paint it.

You will also learn the trickiest thing in Year 2 English: how a writer tells you **WHEN** something happened.

✓ BY THE END OF THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- read a story and say what a character was thinking, using evidence
- write about your own home and something kind you have done
- name a verb, and say whether it happened now or before
- add *-ing* and *-ed* to verbs correctly
- decide whether a sentence about a story is true or not true
- keep a diary as a character from the story

**WARM UP
YOUR
WORDS**

Say something kind somebody did for you this week. It has to be small. Big ones are easy to notice, and this unit is about the other kind.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 1 you learnt what a noun is. Say three nouns you can see in this room.

The Umbrella on the Wall

AN ORIGINAL STORY · PRIME BOOKS · PART ONE

1 It rained all week. Not the interesting kind that comes sideways and blows the bins over, but the flat grey kind that simply keeps going, and by Thursday everybody at Prime School had a coat drying on a peg and wet socks in a bag.

2 On Thursday afternoon Ines was looking out of the window when she saw a woman coming up the hill with four shopping bags and no umbrella. The woman was walking quickly, with her head down and her shoulders up round her ears, and her hair was flat against her face. Ines watched her all the way to the top of the hill and out of sight.

3 That night Ines could not stop thinking about the shoulders. She did not know the woman. She could not have run out with an umbrella, because by the time she had found one the woman would have been gone.

4 On Friday morning she took the red umbrella from the hall, the big one that nobody used because the handle was bent. She tied a brown paper tag to the handle with string. On the tag she wrote nine words, and then she went out and opened the umbrella and stood it on the garden wall, where anybody walking up the hill would see it.

5 The tag said: **Take me if you need me. Bring me back.**



Four bags, no umbrella, and shoulders up round her ears

The story carries on over the page.



Nine words on a brown paper tag

The Umbrella on the Wall

PART TWO

It rained all day. Ines did not look out of the window once, because she had decided not to, and deciding not to look was the hardest part of the whole idea.

The umbrella was gone by four o'clock.

It came back on Tuesday. It was folded, and dry, and standing against the gate with the tag still tied to it, and somebody had written under her nine words, in small careful pencil: **I did need you. Thank you. It has stopped now.**

Ines put it back on the wall anyway.

By the end of the month there were umbrellas on eleven walls up the hill: a green one, two black ones, one enormous striped one outside the bakery, and one that was really a beach parasol and did not fold at all. Nobody organised it. Nobody put up a notice. It simply turned out that once one person has done a thing, the thing becomes possible, and after that it is very hard to stop.



It came back on Tuesday, folded and dry



Eleven walls, and nobody organised it

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

The story says deciding not to look was the hardest part. Why would that be hard?

Talking about the story

WATCH TOMAS TRY 4

Aisha says Ines is shy. Tomas is not sure. How do they settle it?

- 1** They look for what Ines DOES. She does something for a stranger, which is not shy.
- 2** Then they look at HOW she does it. She leaves a tag instead of speaking to anybody, and she refuses to watch.
- 3** Tomas finds the sentence about not looking out of the window and reads it again.
- 4** They decide the story shows somebody who wants to help and does not want to be thanked, which is not the same as shy.

We found out: Ines is not shy: she is private. The evidence is that she helps AND hides, in the same paragraph.

- 1** Why did Ines not run out with an umbrella on Thursday?

- 2** Copy the nine words Ines wrote on the tag.

- 3** Who wrote the second message, and how do you know?

4 Decide whether each sentence is true or not true.

It rained all week. **TRUE** / NOT TRUE

Ines knew the woman with the shopping. **TRUE** / NOT TRUE

Ines watched from the window on Friday. **TRUE** / NOT TRUE

The umbrella came back the same day. **TRUE** / NOT TRUE

Somebody put up a notice about the umbrellas. **TRUE** / NOT TRUE

5 Put these events in order, from first to last.

The umbrella came back. Ines saw the woman on the hill.

Ines tied on the tag. There were umbrellas on eleven walls.

The umbrella was gone by four o'clock.



Somebody you do not know, going up your hill

4.2

Writing about your own place

● WHAT HAPPENED AT PRIME SCHOOL

Beto wrote My house is nice and stopped, because he could not think of anything else true about it.

Then Aisha asked him what you can hear in it. He wrote for ten minutes without looking up. The trick is not to describe the place: it is to answer a question about it.

■ FOUR QUESTIONS THAT UNSTICK ANY DESCRIPTION

- 1 What can you HEAR in it that you would not hear anywhere else?
- 2 What is the oldest thing in it?
- 3 Where does the light come in, and when?
- 4 What is the one thing a visitor always says about it?

4.2 · CONTINUED

6 Answer all four questions about your own home. One line each.

YOUR FOUR ANSWERS

7 Now write three sentences about your home using two of your answers.

8 Write about one kind thing you have done that nobody thanked you for.

4.2 · CONTINUED

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

Beto could not describe his house but could answer questions about it. Why do you think that is?



Reading and writing beyond school

for teachers

literacytrust.org.uk

4.3

Verbs, and when things happened

■ VERBS

A **verb** is a doing or being word: *rained, walked, wrote, is*. Every sentence needs one. Find the verb and you have found what is actually happening in the sentence.

It rained. She tied a tag. The umbrella was gone.

- 9 Underline the verb in each sentence. Then write the four verbs.

The woman carried four bags. Ines opened the umbrella.

The tag says nine words. Nobody organised it.

■ NOW, OR BEFORE?

A verb also tells you WHEN. **I walk** is happening now. **I walked** happened before. Most verbs add **-ed** for something that has already happened, and **-ing** for something going on at the time.

walk + -ed = walked

walk + -ing = walking

rain + -ed = rained

10 Fill in the table. Two are already done for you.

Now	Before (-ed)	Going on (-ing)
walk	walked	walking
open		
look		
want		
ask		

● INES FOUND THIS OUT

Not every verb behaves. Write does not become writed, it becomes wrote, and there are about two hundred more like it in English. You already know almost all of them by ear, which is why nobody has to teach you.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

How do you know *runned* is wrong, when nobody has ever taught you a rule about it?

■ WATCH TOMAS TRY 5

Tomas wrote *Yesterday I walk to school and I am wet*. What is wrong?

- 1 He reads it aloud. It sounds wrong, but he cannot say why.
- 2 He finds the word that says when: *Yesterday*. So the whole sentence is about before.
- 3 He checks each verb against that. *Walk* is now, so it must be *walked*. *Am* is now, so it must be *was*.
- 4 He writes it again: **Yesterday I walked to school and I was wet.**

We found out: if a sentence says when, every verb in it has to agree with the when. Find the time word first.

- 11 Rewrite each sentence so that it happened before.

Happening now	Happened before
I open the door.	
She ties the tag on.	
It rains all day.	
We are late.	

12 Write two sentences about yesterday. Use a *-ed* verb in each.

13 Choose the correct sentence and draw a ring round it.

Last Friday Ines writes on the tag.

Last Friday Ines wrote on the tag.

WORK TOGETHER

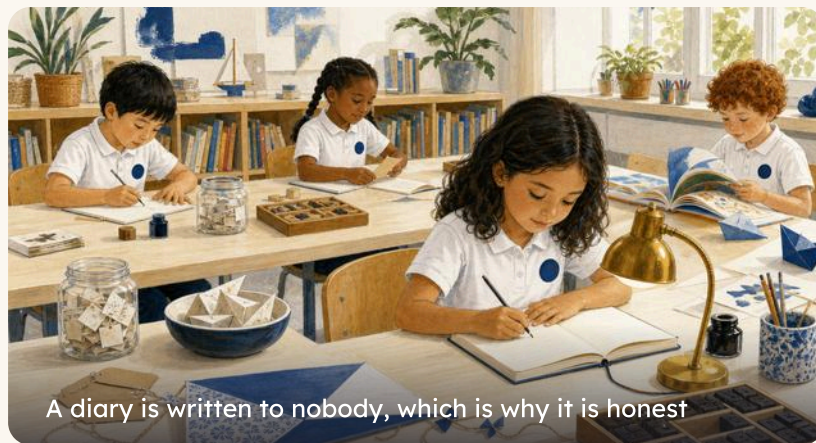
Work in pairs. One says a sentence about now. The other says the same sentence about yesterday. Do ten, then swap.

WHAT YOU NEED

a partner, and somewhere you can talk out loud

THE WORD I FOUND HARD

HOW I WILL REMEMBER IT



4.4

Keeping a diary

WHAT A DIARY IS FOR

A **diary** is writing you do for yourself about what happened to you. It has the date at the top. It is written about things that have already happened, so almost every verb in it is a *before* verb. Nobody else has to understand it.

- 14 Write Thursday's diary entry as Ines, the day she saw the woman.

THURSDAY

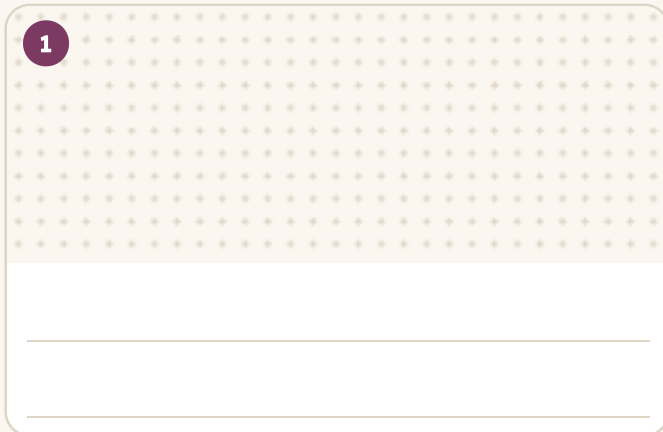
the day it would not stop

- 15** Now write Tuesday's entry, the day the umbrella came back.

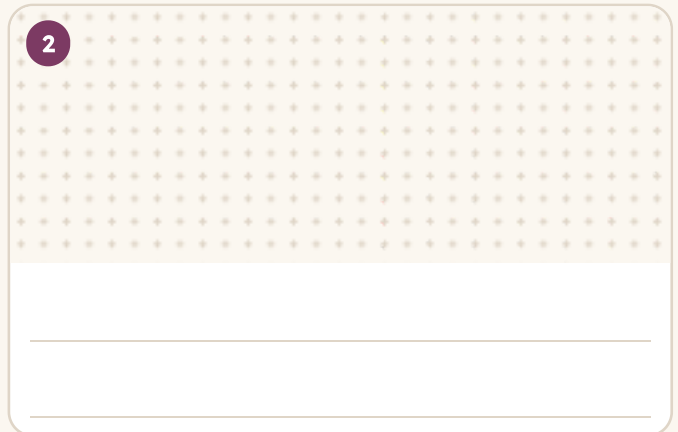
TUESDAY

- 16** Draw two things you did today and write a caption under each.

1



2



➡ **GO FURTHER**

Look back at your two diary entries. Circle every verb that ends in *-ed*. If you have none, you have written them as if they were happening now, and a diary never is.

EVERYTHING IN THIS UNIT

★ A STORY ABOUT ONE SMALL KIND THING

Write your own story about **one small kind thing**, and then change its ending.

- 1 Plan it on a story map. Somebody needs something. Somebody else notices. Then what?
- 2 Your kind thing must be SMALL. Nobody may be rescued, and nobody may be rich at the end.
- 3 Write it. Every verb about the past takes its *before* form.
- 4 Put in one line of talk with speech marks, and one thing written down inside your story, like the tag in ours.
- 5 Read it to a partner. Then write a DIFFERENT ending, where the kind thing does not come back.
- 6 Decide which ending you prefer, and be ready to say why. There is no right answer to that.

■ WHAT YOU NEED

a pencil, this book, your story map, and a partner

BEGINNING



MIDDLE



END

★ BETO'S CHALLENGE

Write your story again in the first person, as *I*, and as the person who RECEIVED the kind thing rather than the person who did it. You will find you have to invent things you never had to decide before, because that person does not know who helped them.

END OF UNIT 4

What you can do now

☐ CHECK WHAT YOU CAN DO

- 1 Name the verb in: *The woman carried four bags.*
- 2 Write the *before* form of *ask*.
- 3 Write the *-ing* form of *look*.
- 4 Why does a diary have the date at the top?
- 5 Write one sentence about yesterday with a *-ed* verb in it.
- 6 Why is *writed* wrong?

	confident	almost there	needs more work
I can find evidence in a story for what somebody was thinking	☐	☐	☐
I can describe my own home by answering questions about it	☐	☐	☐
I can find the verb in a sentence	☐	☐	☐
I can add -ed and -ing to verbs correctly	☐	☐	☐
I can write a diary entry as somebody else	☐	☐	☐

- ✓ You can tell whether a sentence happened now or before, and change it.
- ✓ You can find the verb in any sentence, which is how you find out what is happening in it.
- ✓ You can describe a real place without using the word *nice*.
- ✓ You have written a diary as somebody who is not you.

WORDS FROM THIS UNIT

**umbrella**

a folding cover on a stick that keeps rain off you

**rain**

water falling from clouds

**neighbour**

somebody who lives near you

**diary**

a book you write in about what happened to you

**thank you**

what you say to somebody who has helped you

**verb**

a doing or being word, such as ran or is

**tag**

a small label tied to something

**pencil**

a thin stick of wood with a grey core, for writing and drawing

■ FOR TEACHERS

This unit carries 2Ri.02, 2Ri.06, 2Ri.07, 2Ri.10, 2Ri.12, 2Ri.13, 2Ri.15, 2Rs.01, 2Ra.01, 2Ra.02, 2Rg.06, 2Rw.03, 2Ww.05, 2Ww.06, 2Wg.07, 2Wg.09, 2Wv.03, 2Wv.04, 2Ws.01, 2Wc.01, 2Wc.02, 2Wc.03, 2Wc.04, 2Wp.03, 2Wp.04, 2Wp.05, 2SLm.03, 2SLs.01, 2SLg.02 and 2SLr.01.

Tense is the hardest idea in Year 2 grammar and the commonest way to teach it badly is as a table of endings. This unit teaches it from a time word instead: find *Yesterday* and every verb in the sentence has to agree with it. That is the move in the modelled attempt on page 43 and it is worth rehearsing aloud many times.

The irregular verbs are named honestly and then left alone. Pupils already know almost all of them by ear, and a Year 2 pupil who is told there are two hundred exceptions stops trusting the rule they have just learnt.

Misconceptions this unit tackles head on: that every past verb takes *-ed*, and that a description is improved by adding adjectives rather than by answering a question about the thing.



UNIT FIVE

Creatures we share with

A fable about a gull who paid a kindness back, true writing about dolphins, and the plurals that will not behave.

OPEN THE WORKSHOP

Some stories were written to be enjoyed. A **fable** was written to do something else as well: to teach you one thing, and to do it in as few words as possible.

This unit begins with a fable written for this book. Read it once to find out what happens. Then read it again, because the second time is when you notice what it is teaching you.

✓ BY THE END OF THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- read a fable and say in your own words what its lesson is
- use what a character does as evidence for what they are like
- spell plurals, including the ones that do not add an s
- choose words that describe a storm better than *bad* does
- read true writing about a real creature and use a labelled picture
- design a poster that asks somebody to do something

**WARM UP
YOUR
WORDS**

Name a creature you have seen this week. The next person names one that lives somewhere different. Round the class, no repeats.

■ WHAT A FABLE IS

A **fable** is a very short story written to teach the reader one thing. That one thing is called its **lesson**. Fables are often about animals, and they are always short, because a fable that goes on too long loses the very thing it was written for.

A fable

FOR	teaching one thing in very few words
LOOK FOR	a short story, often animals, something given and something returned, a lesson to work out
YOU MEET IT	story books, assemblies, stories told out loud

An information text

FOR	finding out about something real
LOOK FOR	a title, true facts, real pictures with words naming their parts
YOU MEET IT	school books, museum signs, wildlife programmes

The Gull and the Lighthouse Keeper

AN ORIGINAL FABLE · PRIME BOOKS · PART ONE

1 There was a lighthouse at the end of a long stony point, and a keeper who lived in it on his own. Every evening he climbed the stairs, filled the lamp with oil and lit it, so that the boats coming home could see the rocks.

2 One grey morning he found a herring gull on the shore. It lay in a tangle of seaweed and old fishing line, and one wing was wound round so tightly that it could not open. The gull did not want any help. It snapped at his hands twice.

3 The keeper carried it indoors anyway. He sat at the table with a small pair of scissors and cut the line away thread by thread, talking quietly all the time. “Hold still,” he said. “Nearly done.”

4 When the wing came free the gull stood up on the table, looked at him with one flat yellow eye, and walked out of the open door. Then it flew low over the water, and it did not look back.



A tangle of seaweed, line and one trapped wing



“Hold still. Nearly done.”

The fable carries on over the page.

The Gull and the Lighthouse Keeper

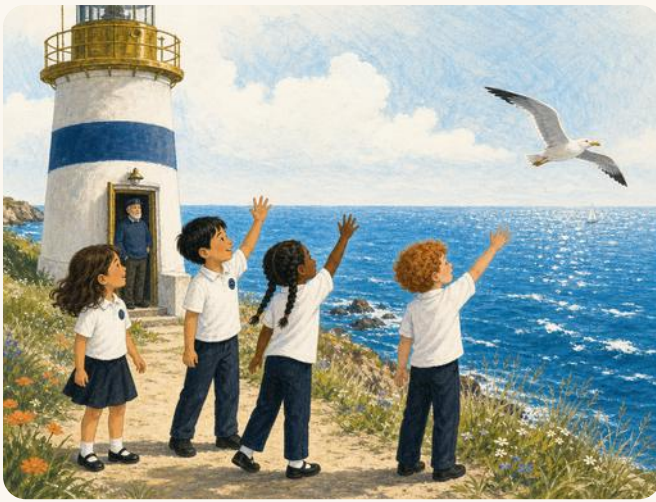
PART TWO

Six weeks later a storm came up out of the west. The keeper lit the lamp, watched the rain run down the glass, and sat down in his chair to wait out the night. He was more tired than he knew, and he fell asleep.

While he slept the lamp burnt the last of its oil and went out. The point went dark. Out at sea a fishing boat came on towards the rocks, and there was nothing to tell it where they were.

Something hit the window. Then it hit the window again, and again, and again. The keeper woke with a jump and saw a wet grey wing beating at the glass, and one flat yellow eye looking in at him.

He was up the stairs before he was properly awake. He filled the lamp, struck a match, and the light swung out across the water. The boat turned away from the rocks. In the morning it came into the harbour with all its crew aboard, and the gull was standing on the mooring post as if it had always been there.



Away over a bright sea, without looking back



A wet grey wing, beating at the glass

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In part one the gull snapped at the keeper twice. Does that change what you think of it now?

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

The words *and again* come three times over. Why do you think the writer put them in three times?

What a fable is for

FINDING THE LESSON

Every **fable** has a **lesson** in it. Some fables print their lesson in one line at the bottom. This one does not, so you have to say it yourself, and the way you do that is to look at what changed between the beginning and the end.

WATCH TOMAS TRY 10

Aisha says this cannot be a fable, because there is no lesson written at the bottom. Is she right?

- 1** Tomas looks at the beginning. The keeper gives something away: an hour of his time, and no reward for it.
- 2** He looks at the end. The gull gives something back, at the one moment it matters most.
- 3** He asks what a reader is meant to carry away from those two things put side by side.
- 4** He writes it in one sentence, in his own words, and finds that it fits the whole story and not just the ending.

We found out: the lesson of a fable does not have to be printed to be there. Aisha was right about the page and wrong about the story, and looking at what changed is how we knew.

- 1** What does the keeper do for the gull? Answer in one sentence.

- 2** Write the lesson of this fable in one sentence.

3 Find the sentence where the kindness comes back. Copy it out.

● INES FOUND THIS OUT

Fables are some of the oldest stories we have. People were telling them in Greece, in India and in West Africa thousands of years ago, long before anybody wrote them down, and that is why the same fable often turns up in several countries at once.

● WORK TOGETHER

Work in pairs. Read part two out loud to each other, one paragraph each, all the way through. Then read it a second time and try to make the storm sound like a storm.

■ WHAT YOU NEED

this book, and a partner to read to

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

You wrote the lesson in your own words. How do you know it fits the whole fable and not only the last part?



5.2

Questions about the fable

WATCH TOMAS TRY 11

Beto says the keeper is soft. Tomas thinks he is something else. How can they settle it?

- 1 They agree on the rule from Unit 1: point at what the character **does**, not at how you feel about him.
- 2 Beto finds his evidence in paragraph 2: the keeper helps a bird that has just bitten him.
- 3 Tomas finds his in paragraph 3: the keeper sits still with scissors, cutting one thread at a time, for a long while.
- 4 They look at both pieces together. Soft does not explain the scissors, and patient explains both.

We found out: the keeper is patient, and paragraph 3 is the proof. Two pupils can disagree and still be settled by the text.

5.2 · CONTINUED

4 Where does this fable happen? Name both places.

5 The gull snaps at the keeper's hands. Why do you think it does that?

6 Put these five events in order, from first to last. Number them 1 to 5.

The lamp went out. The keeper cut the line away.
A boat came in with all its crew. The gull flew away low over the water.
Something hit the window.

7 What sort of person is the keeper? Give one thing he does.

8 Find the word *oilskin* in part one. What might it mean?

5.2 · CONTINUED

 WORK TOGETHER

Work in fours. Take it in turns to ask the group one thing you still want to know about the gull. Nobody may answer until the person asking has finished.

 WHAT YOU NEED

this book, and three other pupils

 HOW DO YOU KNOW?

Two people in your group may see the gull differently. How would you settle it using the fable itself?

5.3

More than one

■ PLURALS

A **plural** means more than one. Most nouns make their plural by adding **s**: one gull, two gulls. Some add **es**: one box, two boxes. A few change in the middle instead: one mouse, two mice. And a few do not change at all: one sheep, two sheep.

one child, two children · one foot, two feet · one fish, two fish

■ WATCH TOMAS TRY 12

Beto has written *three sheeps* and *two mouses*. How does Tomas check them?

- 1 He says both out loud. *Three sheeps* sounds wrong to his ear, and that is worth noticing.
- 2 He remembers that a few words change in the middle rather than at the end, and mouse is one of them.
- 3 He tries the other kind too: one sheep, two sheep. The word does not change at all.
- 4 He checks both in a dictionary, because his ear is good evidence and not proof.

We found out: three sheep and two mice. Sheep never changes, mouse changes in the middle, and the dictionary is how we knew for certain.

9 Write the plural of each noun below.

One	More than one
gull	
child	
sheep	
tooth	
box	
man	

10 Sort these into the right tray.

foot rock goose wing deer woman

Adds s

Changes in the middle

Stays the same

11 One word in each pair is spelt wrongly. Copy the right one.

mice / mouses childs / children fishes / fish

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

You put *deer* in a tray. How do you know it belongs there?

Words for a storm

■ CHOOSING A WORD THAT DOES SOME WORK

The fable never calls the storm *bad*. It shows you rain running down the glass instead, and lets you feel the rest.

An **adjective** tells you more about a noun: *a grey wing, a stony point*. An adjective earns its place only when it tells the reader something they could not already have guessed, so *black* beats *bad* every time.

storm

black

roaring

sudden

12 Write a sentence about the gulls using the word *most*.

13 Choose *tail* or *tale* for each gap. Write the whole sentence.

The gull spread its ... and flew. Grandad told us a ... about a lighthouse.

14 Write two better words for each tired word below.

Tired word	Better	Better
bad (storm)		
big (waves)		
nice (keeper)		
loud (wind)		

15 Choose the better sentence and draw a ring round it. Then say why.

It was a bad night at the lighthouse.

Black rain crawled down the lighthouse glass all night.

16 Write two sentences describing the storm at the lighthouse.

YOUR STORM

THE WORD I FOUND HARD

HOW I WILL REMEMBER IT

➔ GO FURTHER

Find one word in part two of the fable that you would not have thought of yourself. Copy it into your spelling log and use it in a sentence of your own.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

Read your two storm sentences to a partner. How do you know which of your words worked hardest?



Two dolphins, breathing air in the middle of the sea

5.4

True writing about a real creature

Air, echoes and half a sleep

INFORMATION TEXT · EVERY FACT HERE IS A STANDARD ONE, AND THE SOURCES ARE AT THE BACK OF THIS BOOK

1 Bottlenose dolphins live in the sea, but they are not fish. They are mammals, and like you they cannot breathe under water. A dolphin breathes through a **blowhole** on the top of its head. It comes up to the surface, opens the blowhole, takes a breath and shuts it again. A dolphin can stay under water for several minutes before it must come up.

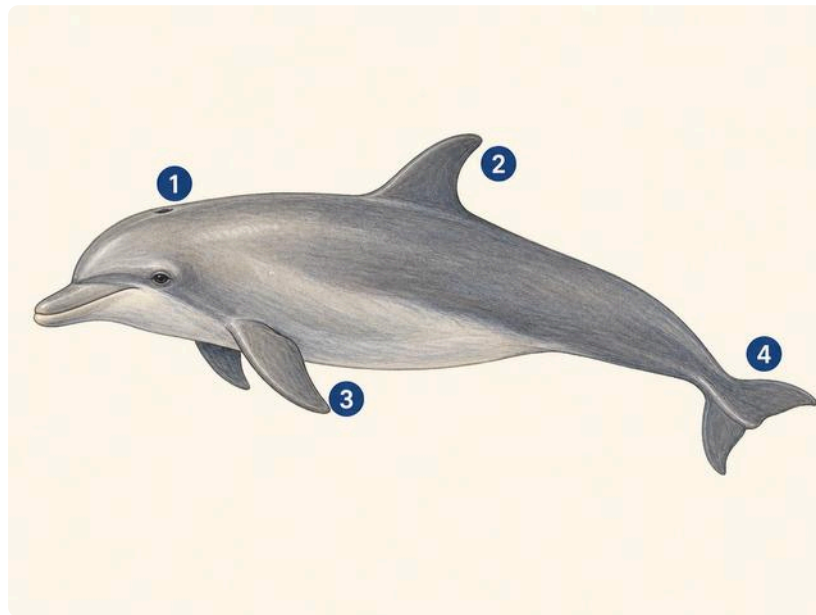
2 Dolphins find their food in a way you cannot. A dolphin makes quick clicking sounds and then listens for the echo. The echo tells it where a fish is and how big it is. This is called **echolocation**, and it works even where the water is too dark to see in.

3 Bottlenose dolphins live in groups called **pods**. They hunt together, and they help to look after each other's young.

4 A dolphin cannot fall fast asleep the way you do, because it would stop breathing. Instead, one half of its brain rests while the other half stays awake, so the dolphin keeps swimming up for air all night long.

READING A DIAGRAM

A **diagram** is a picture drawn to show you how something is made, with a number on each part that matters. A **label** is the writing that tells you what one numbered part is called. You read a diagram by going from the number to its label and back again.



1 **blowhole** the nostril on top of its head, which it breathes through

3 **flipper** one of the two side fins, which it steers with

2 **dorsal fin** the tall fin on its back, which keeps it upright

4 **tail fluke** the flat tail, which it beats up and down to swim

A bottlenose dolphin. Every part of it has a job.

WATCH TOMAS TRY 13

Aisha asks how a dolphin sleeps in the sea without drowning.

- 1 Tomas decides what shape the answer has: it is about sleeping, so he looks for the paragraph about sleeping.
- 2 That is paragraph 4. He reads only that one.
- 3 It says one half of the brain rests while the other half stays awake.
- 4 He asks himself what the awake half is for, and the same sentence tells him: it keeps the dolphin swimming up for air.

We found out: half of a dolphin's brain stays awake so it never stops coming up to breathe. Paragraph 4 says so, and one paragraph was enough.

- 17 Write the number of the part that does each job.

The job	Number
It breathes air in and out.	
It keeps the dolphin upright.	
It pushes the dolphin along.	
It steers the dolphin.	

- 18 How does a dolphin find a fish in dark water?

19 Write four key words from this information text.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

How do you know a dolphin is not a fish? Give two things from the text.



The dolphins in this unit, alive now

for teachers and families

uk.whales.org

EVERYTHING IN THIS UNIT

★ MAKE A CONSERVATION POSTER

Make a **poster** about looking after one sea creature, and put it up where the whole school walks past it.

- 1 Choose your creature. A dolphin, a gull, a crab or a fish. One creature only, so the poster stays clear.
- 2 Find three true facts about it. Two can come from this unit. The third one you look up, and you write down where you found it.
- 3 Write a heading. A heading is not a sentence and it gets no full stop. Keep it short enough to read from the corridor.
- 4 Draw your creature big, in the middle, and put a label on three of its parts.
- 5 Write your promise at the bottom: one thing you will do, starting with the doing word.
- 6 Show it to another class and ask them what they will remember from it tomorrow.

■ WHAT YOU NEED

a big sheet of paper, coloured pencils, your three facts, and another class to show it to

- 20 Write a heading for your poster in six words or fewer.

21 Write one sentence saying what you want people to do.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

You are showing your poster from the front of the room. How will you know the back row has understood it?

★ BETO'S CHALLENGE

Turn your poster into a fable instead. Invent one animal, give it one problem that people caused, and end it in a way that teaches your reader something without ever telling them off.

END OF UNIT 5

What you can do now

☐ CHECK WHAT YOU CAN DO

- 1** Say what every fable has in it, as well as a story.
- 2** Write the plural of *child* and the plural of *sheep*.
- 3** Name the part a dolphin breathes through.
- 4** Give one word for a storm that is better than *bad*.
- 5** Finish this with *tail* or *tale*: the dolphin beat its ...
- 6** Why did the gull come back to the lighthouse window?

	confident	almost there	needs more work
I can read a fable and say what its lesson is	☐	☐	☐
I can use what a character does as my evidence	☐	☐	☐
I can spell plurals, including the awkward ones	☐	☐	☐
I can choose describing words that do some work	☐	☐	☐
I can find information in a labelled diagram	☐	☐	☐

- ✓ You can say what a fable is for, and work out a lesson nobody printed for you.
- ✓ You can settle a disagreement about a character by going back to the text.
- ✓ You can spell plurals that add s, plurals that change and plurals that stay still.
- ✓ You can read true writing about a real creature and pull the key words out of it.
- ✓ You have made a poster that asks a whole school to do something.

WORDS FROM THIS UNIT

**gull**

a large grey and white seabird

**dolphin**

a sea mammal that breathes air and hunts fish

**lighthouse**

a tower with a lamp that warns boats of rocks

**shore**

the land right at the edge of the sea

**ocean**

a very large sea

**promise**

when you say you will certainly do something

**fable**

a very short story written to teach a lesson

**plural**

the word you use when there is more than one

■ FOR TEACHERS

This unit carries 2Ri.02, 2Ri.03, 2Ri.04, 2Ri.08, 2Ri.09, 2Ri.12, 2Ri.15, 2Ri.16, 2Rs.02, 2Ra.01, 2Ra.05, 2Rv.01, 2Rv.04, 2Ww.04, 2Ww.07, 2Wv.02, 2Wv.04, 2Wg.08, 2Ws.03, 2Wc.03, 2Wp.03, 2SLm.05, 2SLs.02, 2SLg.04 and 2SLp.01.

The fable prints no lesson at the bottom, and that is the whole design of topic 5.1. A printed lesson turns the reading into copying. Pupils who cannot start should be sent back to the two givings, in paragraph 3 and in the last paragraph, and asked what changed between them.

The plural work is deliberately built round the pupils' own ears. *Sheeps* and *mouses* are regular formations by a pupil who has understood the commonest pattern, not careless errors, so the modelled attempt says both out loud first and only then reaches for a dictionary.

Misconceptions this unit tackles head on: that a story with no printed lesson at the bottom cannot be a fable, and that every plural is made by putting an s on the end.



UNIT SIX

Safe and sound

How to find what you need inside a book, and one thing worth knowing about water that most grown-ups get wrong.

OPEN THE WORKSHOP

A non-fiction book is built to be used, not read from the front. It has machinery in it for finding things: a contents page at the front, subheadings inside, and sometimes an index at the back. This unit is about working that machinery.

The text you will practise on is about being safe near water, and one thing in it surprises almost everybody.

■ THE MACHINERY OF A NON-FICTION BOOK

A **contents page** is at the FRONT. It lists the parts of a book in the order they come, with page numbers. An **index** is at the BACK, and lists things in alphabetical order. A **subheading** is a small heading inside a text that says what the next part is about.

✓ BY THE END OF THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- use a contents page to find the page you need
- use subheadings to find the right part of a text
- read a labelled diagram and say what each label points at
- break a long word into syllables so you can read it
- use a rhyming pattern to help you spell
- write a sentence that warns somebody clearly

**WARM UP
YOUR
WORDS**

Say a place where you have to be careful. Now say what you have to be careful OF there. The second one is harder and it is the one that matters.

A contents page

FOR	seeing how a book is arranged
LOOK FOR	at the front, in page order, with page numbers
YOU MEET IT	the front of almost any non-fiction book

An index

FOR	finding one thing without reading the book
LOOK FOR	at the back, in alphabetical order, with page numbers
YOU MEET IT	the back of longer information books

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 2 you learnt to skim for a fact. This unit is the step before that: finding which page to skim.

Using a real contents page

Here is the contents page of a short book about staying safe. Use it to answer the questions.

Staying Safe: contents

1 Being careful is not being frightened	2
2 Safe near roads	5
3 Safe near water	9
Rivers and canals	10
The sea	12
Swimming pools	14
4 Safe with animals	17
5 Safe in the kitchen	21
6 Who to tell, and how	25
Index	29

WATCH TOMAS TRY 7

Beto has to find out about swimming pools. How does he do it without reading anything?

- 1 He goes to the contents page, not to page 1.
- 2 He looks down the list for the word *water*, because a swimming pool is water. He finds chapter 3 on page 9.
- 3 Under chapter 3 he finds the indented lines, which are the parts inside it, and one of them says swimming pools.
- 4 He turns to page 14. Total pages read before he got there: one.

We found out: the contents page took Beto straight to page 14, and the indented lines under a chapter are what made it possible.

1 On which page does the chapter about roads begin?

2 How many pages long is chapter 3? Show your working.

3 Where would you look to find out about dogs?

4 Which comes first: the index or chapter 6?

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

The lines about rivers and the sea are indented. How does that help you, before you read a word of them?

Safe near water

INFORMATION TEXT · ADVICE FROM THE ROYAL NATIONAL LIFEBOAT INSTITUTION, SEE PAGE 114

1 Being careful is not being frightened. Water is one of the best things there is. Almost everybody who reads this will spend a happy day beside some this year. Being safe near it is not about being afraid of it: it is about knowing four or five things, so that you can stop thinking about them and enjoy yourself.

2 Swim where somebody is watching. The single most useful rule is to swim where there is a lifeguard, and to swim with somebody rather than alone. A lifeguard is not there because swimming is dangerous. A lifeguard is there because somebody watching the water is the thing that most often makes a difference.

3 Cold water is the surprise. Here is the part most people do not know. Cold water does not only feel unpleasant: it makes your muscles stop working properly, quite quickly, and it does this to strong swimmers exactly as it does to weak ones. Being good at swimming does not protect you from it. That is why the sea in a cold country can be difficult even on a hot day, because the air being warm tells you nothing at all about the water.

Safe near water *continued*

If you fall in, float first. If you go into cold water without meaning to, the advice is to float on your back, keep still, and let your breathing settle before you try to do anything else. Fighting the water is what uses you up. Once your breathing is calm again you can shout for help or swim.

A life ring is thrown, never carried. If somebody else is in trouble, the rule is to tell an adult and to throw something that floats. You do not go in after them. That sounds hard, and it is: it is also the advice every lifeboat service in the world gives, because two people in the water is worse than one.

Signs and flags are worth reading. A flag or a sign at a beach or a river tells you where it is safe and where it is not, and somebody who knows that stretch of water put it there this morning. Reading it takes four seconds.



Being safe near water

for teachers, before the safety lesson

[rnli.org/safety](https://www.rnli.org/safety)

Finding the answers

Every one of these can be answered from the text on page 65. Use the subheadings to find the right paragraph first.

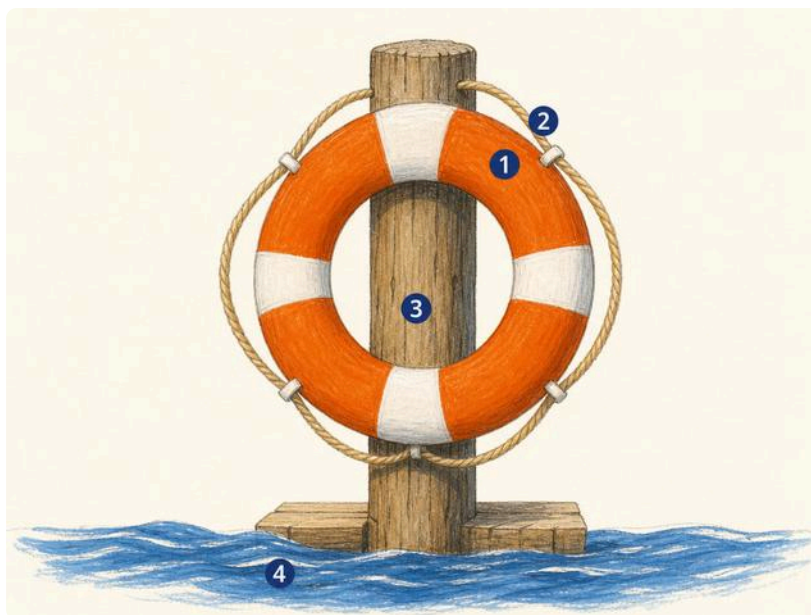
5 Why is a lifeguard there? Answer in your own words.

6 What does cold water do to your muscles?

7 Does being a strong swimmer protect you from cold water?

8 What are you told to do first if you fall in?

9 Why is it wrong to swim out to somebody in trouble?



1 **The ring** it floats, and it is thrown to the person

2 **The rope** so the person can be pulled in from the bank

3 **The post** it always lives in the same place, so it can be found

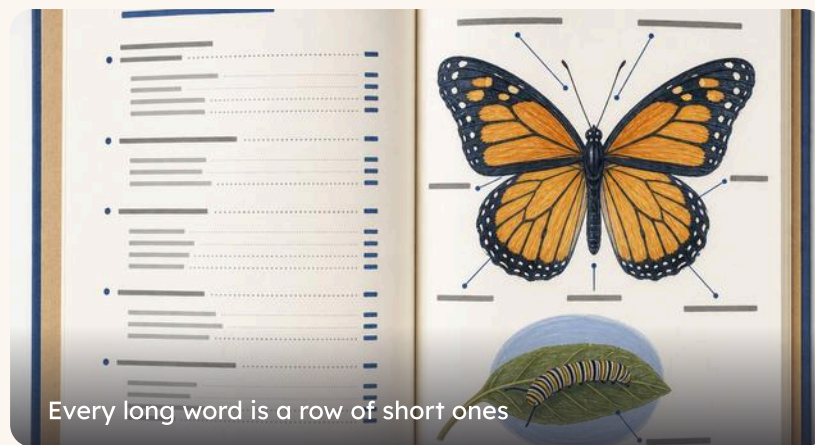
4 **The water** where the person is, and where you do not go

A life ring on its post, with four parts labelled

10 Which labelled part means you do not have to go in?

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

The text says the air being warm tells you nothing about the water. How does that fit with the paragraph before it?



6.3

Reading a long word

SYLLABLES HELP YOU READ, NOT JUST CLAP

In Unit 1 you clapped syllables. Here is what they are actually for.

A **syllable** is a beat in a word. When you meet a long word you have never seen, you break it into syllables and read them one at a time. That is how you read a word nobody has taught you.

lifeguard

life

guard

2 beats

dangerous

dan

ger

ous

3 beats

difficult

dif

fi

cult

3 beats

emergency

e

mer

gen

cy

4 beats

11 Break these words into syllables and read them aloud.

breathing

swimming

carefully

understand

12 Sort these words by how many beats they have.

flag water lifeboat sign remember cold

One beat

Two beats

Three beats

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

You have probably never read the word *emergency* out loud before. How did you manage it?

Spelling by pattern**■ A PATTERN YOU ALREADY KNOW SPELLS WORDS YOU DO NOT**

Words that **rhyme** often share a spelling pattern. If you can spell one of them, you can spell all of them, and that is quicker than learning each one on its own.

THE OAT LADDER

coat

boat

float

throat

THE IGH T LADDER

light

night

right

fright

13 Write two more words that rhyme with *float* and share its spelling.

14 Complete each word with *oat* or *ight*.

Start of the word	Finished word
a fl____ ing ring	
turn on the l____	
put on your c____	
it happened at n____	

● INES FOUND THIS OUT

The word float and the word flotilla, which means a small fleet of boats, come from the same very old word. English keeps the family and changes the spelling, which is annoying and also the reason it has so many words.

THE WORD I FOUND HARD**HOW I WILL REMEMBER IT**

➔ GO FURTHER

Find three words in the safety text on page 65 that have the *ight* pattern or the *oat* pattern in them.



6.4

Writing a warning

A WARNING THAT WORKS

A **command** tells somebody to do something. A good warning is a command plus a reason, joined with **because**: *Read the flag before you swim, because somebody put it there this morning.* A warning with no reason gets ignored.

THE SENTENCE BENCH

because

if

when

so

but

Float on your back _____ fighting the water uses you up.

Throw the ring _____

two people in the water is worse than one.

15 Write a warning about cold water. Use *because*.

16 Write a warning for a younger child about a road.

17 Sort these into the right tray.

a paddling pool a fast river a lifeguarded beach a canal with no fence
a garden pond a swimming lesson

Fine on your own

Needs an adult

18 Decide whether each sentence is true or not true.

Good swimmers do not feel cold water.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

A lifeguard watches the water.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

You should swim out to somebody in trouble.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

You should float first if you fall in.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

 WORK TOGETHER

Work in pairs. Choose one of your warnings and say it to your partner as if they were five. Then ask them to say the reason back to you. If they cannot, your reason was not clear enough.

 WHAT YOU NEED

your two warnings, and a partner

EVERYTHING IN THIS UNIT

★ MAKE A SAFETY BOOK

Make a **short safety book** for a younger class, with a working contents page.

- 1 Choose four places where you have to be careful. One of them must be water.
- 2 One page each. Give every page a subheading, two warnings with reasons, and a labelled diagram.
- 3 Number your pages, then make the contents page LAST, because you cannot write page numbers before the pages exist.
- 4 Give each chapter a title that says what is in it, not a clever one. A contents page is for finding things.
- 5 Test it. Give it to somebody and ask them to find one thing using only the contents page.
- 6 If they could not find it, change the contents page and not the chapter.

■ WHAT YOU NEED

four sheets of paper, a pencil, coloured pencils, and somebody younger to test it on

Your contents page

- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4

★ BETO'S CHALLENGE

Add an index at the back of your book. It has to be in alphabetical order and every page number in it must be right, which means you have to check every one. This is exactly the job somebody did for the word list at the back of this book.

END OF UNIT 6

What you can do now

☐ CHECK WHAT YOU CAN DO

- 1 Where in a book is the contents page, and where is the index?
- 2 Break *lifeboat* into syllables.
- 3 Write a word that rhymes with *night* and shares its spelling.
- 4 What is the first thing to do if you fall into cold water?
- 5 Why does a warning need a reason?
- 6 What does a subheading tell a reader?

	confident	almost there	needs more work
I can use a contents page to find the page I need	☐	☐	☐
I can use subheadings to find the right paragraph	☐	☐	☐
I can read a labelled diagram	☐	☐	☐
I can break a long word into syllables and read it	☐	☐	☐
I can write a warning with a reason in it	☐	☐	☐

- ✓ You can find one thing in a non-fiction book without reading it.
- ✓ You can read a word you have never seen, by breaking it up.
- ✓ You can spell a group of words from one pattern instead of one at a time.
- ✓ You know the thing about cold water that most adults do not.

WORDS FROM THIS UNIT

**warning**

something that tells you about a danger before you meet it

**life ring**

a ring that floats, thrown to somebody in the water

**helmet**

a hard hat that protects the head

**jellyfish**

a soft, almost see-through sea animal that can sting

**riverbank**

the land at the edge of a river

**contents page**

a list at the front of a book showing its parts in order

**subheading**

a small heading inside a text saying what the next part is about

**syllable**

a beat in a word

■ FOR TEACHERS

This unit carries 2Ri.01, 2Ri.04, 2Ri.05, 2Ri.06, 2Ri.09, 2Ri.13, 2Ri.14, 2Ri.15, 2Rs.02, 2Rs.03, 2Rw.05, 2Rw.06, 2Rv.01, 2Rg.04, 2Ra.04, 2Ww.02, 2Ww.03, 2Ww.08, 2Ww.10, 2Wg.04, 2Wg.06, 2Ws.03, 2Wc.04, 2Wc.05, 2Wp.03, 2Wp.04, 2SLm.02, 2SLs.01, 2SLg.03 and 2SLr.03.

The tone is deliberately calm and the unit opens by saying so. Safety teaching that frightens a six-year-old produces a child who avoids water rather than one who is safe in it, and the first paragraph of the text exists to make that explicit.

The cold-water paragraph is the one worth teaching hardest. It is genuinely counter-intuitive, most adults do not know it, and it is the single piece of information in this unit most likely to matter. All of it is standard RNLI advice, sourced on page 114.

Misconceptions this unit tackles head on: that being a strong swimmer protects you from cold water, that you should swim out to somebody in trouble, and that a contents page can be written before the pages it lists.



UNIT SEVEN

The night Rui would not sleep

A story about being wide awake when everybody else is not. Then suffixes, alphabetical order, and a poem to learn by heart.

OPEN THE WORKSHOP

Everybody has had a night like Rui's. This story is about one, and it was written for this book.

Listen to it first, read aloud, before you read it yourself. A story about being awake in a quiet house works better in a voice than on a page, and hearing it once makes reading it easier.

✓ BY THE END OF THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- listen to a story and follow it, then read it for yourself
- answer questions about a character by finding your evidence
- add suffixes to words to make new words
- put words in alphabetical order and use a glossary
- learn a poem by heart and say it to an audience
- write a short news report about an interview

**WARM UP
YOUR
WORDS**

Say something you can hear right now. Then something you could hear if everybody stopped talking. Then something you could hear only in the middle of the night.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 1 you learnt what speech marks do. Find the first line of talk on the next page and say who said it.

**Why sleep matters**

for teachers and families

[nhs.uk, sleep and tiredness](https://nhs.uk/sleep-and-tiredness)

The Night Rui Would Not Sleep

AN ORIGINAL STORY · PRIME BOOKS · PART ONE

1 Rui was not tired. He wanted everybody to know it. He had said so at half past seven, and again at eight, and he was still saying it at half past eight from the top of the stairs.

2 “I am not tired,” he called down. “I have never been less tired in my life.”

“Bed,” said his mother, without looking up.

3 So Rui went to his room, but he did not get into bed. He got his torch instead, and he sat on the floor and built a tower out of wooden blocks. It was the tallest tower he had ever built. There was nobody awake to see it.

4 The tower fell over. Rui listened. Nobody came.

5 He went to the window and pulled the curtain back. Outside, the garden had gone a strange grey-blue, and everything in it was the wrong colour. The washing line was still there. The shed was still there. On the line, where no bird sits in the daytime, there was an owl.



Half past eight, and still not tired

The story carries on over the page.



The tallest tower, and nobody awake to see it

The Night Rui Would Not Sleep

PART TWO

It turned its head all the way round and looked at Rui. Rui looked back. Neither of them moved for a very long time.

“I am not tired either,” the owl did not say, because owls do not talk. But Rui thought it anyway, and it seemed to him the most sensible thing anybody had thought all evening.

He stayed at the window while the owl waited. He was still there when it dropped off the line and went across the garden without a sound, and he was still there when the grey-blue got darker and the shed stopped being a shed and became a shape.

Then Rui was cold. He got into bed to get warm, only to get warm, and he was asleep before he had finished thinking about how he was not going to fall asleep.

In the morning his mother found him with one arm out of the covers and the torch still on, shining at nothing under the blanket, and the fallen tower all over the floor. She stood in the doorway and laughed quietly so as not to wake him, because now, of course, he was very hard to wake indeed.



On the line, where no bird sits in the daytime



Very hard to wake indeed

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

The story never says Rui was tired. How do you know he was?

Talking about the story

WATCH TOMAS TRY 7

Aisha thinks Rui was tired all along. Where is her evidence?

- 1** Tomas looks for what Rui SAYS: he says three times that he is not tired. That is evidence the other way.
- 2** So he looks for what Rui DOES instead. Rui gets into bed only to get warm.
- 3** Then he finds the next sentence: Rui is asleep before he has finished the thought.
- 4** He decides that what a character does beats what a character says.

We found out: Aisha is right, and the proof is in the last two sentences: somebody who is not tired does not fall asleep mid-thought.

- 1** Why does Rui get his torch instead of getting into bed?

- 2** Find the sentence that tells you the garden looked different at night. Copy it.

- 3 The owl does not talk. Write the words Rui thought it would have said.
-
-

- 4 Put these five events in order, from first to last.

The tower fell over. Rui saw the owl. Rui got cold.
Rui called down the stairs. His mother laughed quietly.

- 5 Why does his mother laugh quietly and not loudly?
-
-

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

Rui and the owl look at each other for a long time. Why do you think Rui liked the owl so much?



7.2

Endings that change a word

SUFFIXES

A **root word** is the word you start with. A **suffix** is an ending you add to it to make a new word. The root usually stays exactly the same underneath, which is why spotting it helps you read a long word and spell it.

sleep + -y = sleepy

care + -ful = careful

quiet + -ly = quietly

dark + -er = darker

tall + -est = tallest

- 6 Find three words with suffixes in the story. Write the root of each one.

The word in the story	Its root	Its suffix
-----------------------	----------	------------

- 7 Add -ly to these words: *slow*, *soft*, *sudden*.

- 8 Sort these into the right tray by their suffix.

helpful louder sleepy kindly smallest rainy

-y or -ful	-er or -est	-ly

SUFFIXES THAT COMPARE

-er compares two things: *the shed was darker than the tree.* **-est** means the most out of all of them: *the tallest tower he had ever built.* You cannot use **-est** about only two things.

9 Complete each sentence with the right ending.

Sentence	Your answer
The owl was quiet___ than Rui.	
It was the tall___ tower of all.	
The garden went dark___ and dark___.	

10 Write one sentence using *quieter* and one using *quietest*.

INES FOUND THIS OUT

An owl can fly almost silently because the front edge of its wing feathers is fringed like a comb, which breaks up the rush of air instead of letting it whistle.

Putting words in order

ALPHABETICAL ORDER

Alphabetical order means putting words in the order of the alphabet, using the first letter. If two words start with the same letter, you look at the second letter instead. It is how a glossary, a dictionary and an index are arranged.

A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

- 11 Put these words in alphabetical order, from a to z.

torch owl window shed stairs

- 12 Find *ow*/ in the word list at the back of this book. Write its page number.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

Shed and *stairs* both start with s. How did you decide which came first?



7.3

A poem to learn by heart

Two Things Awake

The house is asleep and the house is loud:

the fridge has a hum and the pipes have a knock,
the stairs have a creak they save until now,
and somewhere downstairs there is only the clock.

The garden is asleep and the garden is wide:

the shed is a shape and the line is a thread,
the grass has gone grey and the roses have too,
and there on the line is an owl, and its head
turns all the way round to the window and me.

We look at each other. We do not agree
with anyone saying that we should be sleeping.

We two are the only two things that are keeping

An original poem for this book

Two Things Awake *continued*

the whole of the night from going to waste.

Then it drops off the line and it goes, in a haste
of no sound at all, and I am on my own,

and the night is too big, and I want to go home
to my bed, which is here, which is two steps away.

So I go. And that is the end of the day.

- 13** Read the poem out loud twice. Then find two words that rhyme in the first verse.

Learning it, and saying it

■ HOW TO LEARN A POEM BY HEART

- 1** Read the whole poem out loud once, so you know where it is going.
- 2** Learn the first verse only. Say it until you can do it without looking.
- 3** Add the second verse to the first. Always say it from the beginning.
- 4** Keep adding one verse at a time. Never start in the middle.
- 5** Say it to somebody. That is different from saying it to yourself, and it is the part that makes it stick.

WATCH TOMAS TRY 8

Beto keeps getting stuck at the third verse. What does Tomas tell him?

- 1** He asks Beto to say it from the start. Beto gets to verse three and stops in the same place.
- 2** Tomas looks at what comes just before the sticking point: the line ends with *and its head*, which does not sound finished.
- 3** That is the point: the sentence carries on into the next verse, so Beto is waiting for a full stop that is not there.
- 4** Tomas gets him to say the last line of verse two and the first line of verse three together, as one sentence, twenty times.

We found out: the hard place in a poem is usually where a sentence crosses a gap. Practise across the gap, not up to it.

- 14** Learn the first two verses by heart. Say them to a partner.
- 15** Which line in the poem do you like best? Copy it and say why.

 WORK TOGETHER

In pairs, say the poem to each other. The listener's job is to say one thing that was good about how it was said, not about the poem: loud enough, slow enough, or a good pause somewhere.

 WHAT YOU NEED

this book, a partner, and somewhere you can speak out loud

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 3 you compared two poems about soup. Is this poem a complaint or a defence of being awake at night?

 BETO'S CHALLENGE

Write one more verse for this poem, in the same shape: four lines, and the second and fourth ending with the same sound. Put something else awake in it.

EVERYTHING IN THIS UNIT

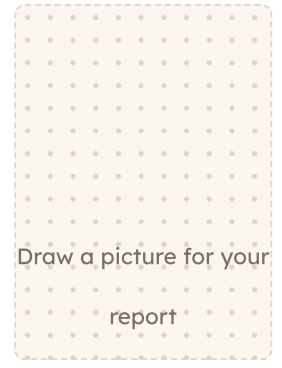
★ INTERVIEW AND REPORT

Interview somebody about a night they could not sleep, then write it up as a **short news report**.

- 1 Write your four questions before you interview anybody. Who, what, where, when.
- 2 Interview a partner in role as Rui, or interview a real person about a real night.
- 3 Write their answers down as you go. You will not remember them.
- 4 Turn it into a report: headline first, then the four facts in one sentence.
- 5 Put in one line of what they actually said, with speech marks round it.
- 6 Read it back to the person you interviewed and check you have not changed what they meant.

THE NIGHT DESK

YOUR HEADLINE



Draw a picture for your
report

■ WHAT YOU NEED

four questions written down, a pencil, and somebody to interview

➔ GO FURTHER

Add a caption under your picture naming who is in it and what they are doing. A caption is not a title: it tells a reader something the picture cannot.

END OF UNIT 7

What you can do now

☐ CHECK WHAT YOU CAN DO

- 1 Write the root word of *sleepy*.
- 2 Add *-est* to *quiet* and use it in a sentence.
- 3 Put in alphabetical order: *night, owl, nest*.
- 4 Say the first verse of **Two Things Awake** from memory.
- 5 Write one sentence saying what Rui does instead of sleeping.
- 6 Why can you not use *-est* when you compare only two things?

	confident	almost there	needs more work
I can find evidence in a story for what a character is like	☐	☐	☐
I can add suffixes and find the root word underneath	☐	☐	☐
I can put words in alphabetical order	☐	☐	☐
I can say a poem from memory to other people	☐	☐	☐
I can write up an interview as a report	☐	☐	☐

- ✓ You can tell what a character is really like from what they do.
- ✓ You can build new words with *-y*, *-ful*, *-ly*, *-er* and *-est*.
- ✓ You can find a word in a glossary, because you know how it is ordered.
- ✓ You know a poem by heart, which nobody can take off you.
- ✓ You have interviewed somebody and written up what they said.

WORDS FROM THIS UNIT

**moon**

the large round light in the night sky

**owl**

a bird that hunts at night and flies silently

**pillow**

the soft cushion you rest your head on

**dream**

the pictures and stories in your head while you sleep

**torch**

a small lamp you hold in your hand

**suffix**

an ending added to a word to make a new word

**root word**

the word a longer word is built on

**alphabetical order**

the order of the alphabet, used in glossaries and indexes

■ FOR TEACHERS

This unit carries 2Ri.02, 2Ri.06, 2Ri.08, 2Ri.10, 2Ri.12, 2Ri.13, 2Ri.15, 2Ri.16, 2Rs.01, 2Ra.01, 2Ra.02, 2Ra.03, 2Rw.03, 2Rv.03, 2Ww.06, 2Wg.03, 2Wg.07, 2Wg.10, 2Wc.01, 2Wc.04, 2Wp.04, 2SLm.03, 2SLs.01, 2SLs.02, 2SLp.01, 2SLp.04 and 2SLr.02.

The story is meant to be read aloud to the class before pupils read it themselves. It was written with that in mind: the sentences are long where the night is slow and short where Rui listens.

The poem is set without rhyme letters in the margin, unlike the Unit 1 poem, because by now pupils should be finding the pattern themselves. The sticking point Tomas diagnoses is real: the sentence that runs across the verse break at *and its head* is where almost every child stops.

Misconceptions this unit tackles head on: that a suffix changes the spelling of the root (usually it does not), and that -est can be used when comparing two things.



UNIT EIGHT

The jar of stars

Guess a story before you read it, then find out. Then write the same story a second way, using nothing but your own words.

OPEN THE WORKSHOP

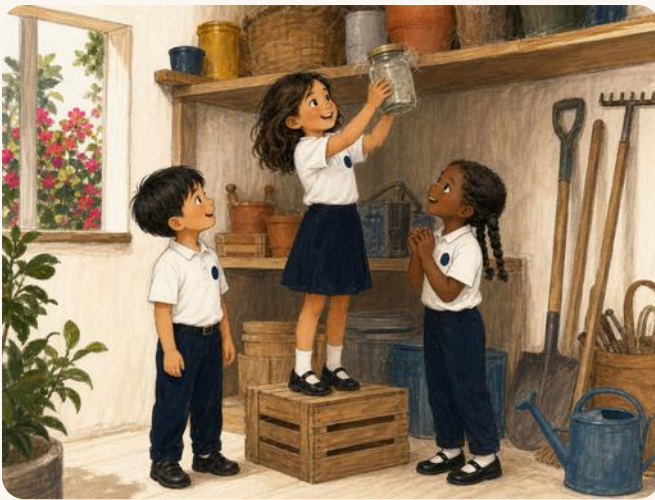
Before you read anything in this unit, you are going to guess what it is about. Not wildly: from evidence. A book gives you a lot before you open it.

✓ BY THE END OF THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- predict what a story is about from its cover, and give your reasons
- read aloud in pairs, taking turns fairly
- use adjectives to describe, including comparing two things
- join two sentences with *and* or *but*
- write questions, and punctuate them
- write the same story a second way using picture clues

■ PREDICTING FROM A COVER

To **predict** is to say what you think will happen before you know. A good prediction is not a lucky guess: it points at the evidence it came from. Being wrong is fine. Having no reason is not.



The front: a jar on a high shelf, and somebody climbing for it



The back: the jar being given away at night

WATCH TOMAS TRY 9

How does Tomas make a prediction he can defend?

- 1 He names what he can actually see on the front: a dusty jar, a high shelf, a child on a crate.
- 2 He names what he can see on the back: the same jar, glowing, being handed to a smaller child.
- 3 He puts them in order. The jar is found first and given away last.
- 4 He predicts: **somebody finds something that turns out to be worth giving away.** Then he says which picture gave him each half.

We found out: a prediction with its evidence attached: found on the front, given away on the back.

1 Write your own prediction about this story in one sentence.

2 Write the one thing in the pictures that made you predict that.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

Two people in your class predicted different things from the same two pictures. How can both be sensible?

The Jar of Stars

AN ORIGINAL STORY · PRIME BOOKS · PART ONE

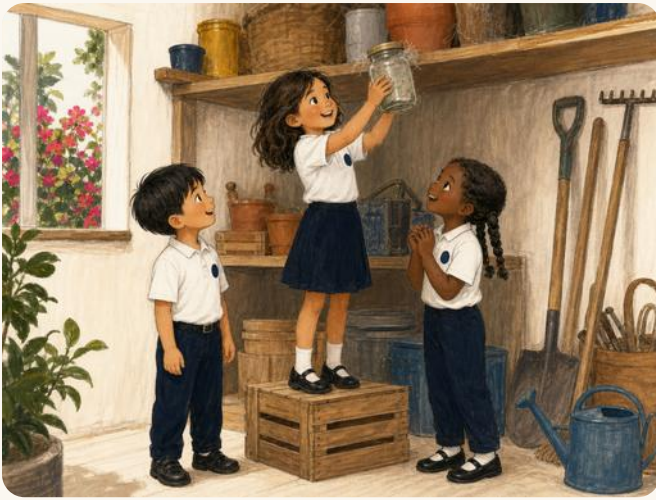
1 The jar was at the back of the top shelf in the shed, behind a tin of screws, and Aisha only found it because she was looking for something else. It was heavy. It was thick with dust. It had a metal lid that had gone green at the edges, and she had to stand on a crate to get both hands round it.

2 She carried it out into the daylight and rubbed a window in the dust with her sleeve. Inside there was nothing at all. She turned it over. Still nothing. She was about to put it back.

3 Then a cloud went over the sun, and in the sudden grey Aisha saw that the jar was not empty. It was full of small points of light, hundreds of them, so faint that any brightness at all drowned them out.

4 She took it into the shed and shut the door. In the dark the jar was beautiful. The lights drifted and turned, slow as dust in a sunbeam, and where they came near the glass they went a little brighter, as if they were looking out.

5 Aisha opened the lid.



Behind a tin of screws, and thick with dust



She opened the lid

Stop here. Before you turn over, write one sentence saying what you think Aisha will do with the jar.

The Jar of Stars

PART TWO

They came out slowly. They went up past her face and up past the shelves and they spread across the low wooden ceiling of the shed until the whole of it was a map of stars, and Aisha lay down on the floor among the flowerpots to look at it properly.

She stayed there a long time. Then she thought about her brother, who was four, and who was frightened of his bedroom at night, and who had told her so and asked her not to tell anybody.

It took her most of the evening to get them back in. She had to stand very still and wait, and let them come to the jar in their own time, and it was almost dark outside when she screwed the lid down again.

She did not wrap it. She carried it up and knocked on his door with her elbow because both her hands were full.

“It is not a present,” she said. “You have to give it to somebody else afterwards. That is the rule.”

Her brother took it with both hands. He did not ask who made the rule.



The whole ceiling became a map of stars



"It is not a present."

- 3** Look back at the prediction you wrote on page 87. Were you right? Write what you got right and what you did not.

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

The story never says Aisha loves her brother. How do you know she does?

Reading it aloud together

READING IN PAIRS

When two people read one story, you take turns at a full stop, never in the middle of a sentence. The person not reading follows the words with their eyes, so they can take over without a gap.

● WORK TOGETHER

In pairs, read part two of the story out loud, swapping at every full stop. Then read it again, swapping at every paragraph instead, and decide which way sounded better.

■ WHAT YOU NEED

this book, and a partner

- 4** Which way of swapping sounded better? Write one sentence saying why.

- 5** Find the shortest paragraph in the story. Why do you think it is so short?

- 6** What is the rule Aisha makes? Write it in your own words.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 7 you learnt to find the root inside a longer word. Find the root of *brightness*.

**Find the next story to share**

for teachers and families, to choose a book

booktrust.org.uk, Bookfinder



8.2

Describing, and comparing

ADJECTIVES THAT COMPARE

In Unit 1 you learnt that an **adjective** tells you more about a noun. Here is what happens when you use one to compare two things.

Add **-er** to compare two: *the jar was heavier than the tin*. Add **-est** for the most out of all of them: *the faintest light in the jar*. For a long adjective you use *more* and *most* instead: *more beautiful*, never *beautifuller*.

jar

dusty

heavy

green-lidded

8.2 • CONTINUED

7 Write the comparing forms of these words.

Adjective	Comparing two	The most of all
dark		
faint		
heavy		
beautiful		

8 Choose the correct sentence and draw a ring round it.

The shed was darker than the garden.

The shed was darkest than the garden.

9 Write one sentence comparing the jar with something in your classroom.

● INES FOUND THIS OUT

The faintest stars you can see with your eyes alone are about two thousand five hundred on a really dark night, and almost none at all in a town, because streetlights drown them out in exactly the way daylight drowned out the jar.

8.3

Joining and asking

JOINING TWO SENTENCES

A **connective** is a word that joins. *And* adds something: *She lifted the lid and the lights came out.* *But* shows a difference: *It looked empty but it was full.* Only join two sentences that belong together.

THE SENTENCE BENCH

and

but

because

if

when

It looked empty _____ it was full.

She shut the door _____ the jar was beautiful.

He took it with both hands _____ he did not ask why.

10 Join each pair with *and* or *but*. Choose carefully.

Two sentences

Joined

The jar was heavy. She carried it out.

She looked inside. She saw nothing.

Her brother was four. He was frightened at night.

QUESTIONS

A **question** asks something and ends with a **question mark**.
Many questions start with *who*, *what*, *where*, *when*, *why* or *how*.

- 11** Write three questions you would ask Aisha about the jar.

YOUR QUESTIONS

- 12** Turn this into a question: *The jar was on the top shelf.*

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

How do you know that *but* is right in the second pair and *and* is wrong?

FINAL PROJECT

EVERYTHING IN THIS UNIT

★ WRITE IT A SECOND WAY

Write **the same story a second way**, using your own word jar. The events do not change. Everything else does.

- 1 Spread out all the word slips you have collected since September. All of them.
- 2 Choose eight you like the look of. Do not think about the story yet.
- 3 Now plan the story again on a story map, beginning, middle and end, in your own words.
- 4 Write it, and get all eight of your chosen words into it somewhere.
- 5 Include two lines of talk with speech marks, one joined sentence with *but*, and one question.
- 6 Read it to a partner. Ask them to name the eight words you chose. If they cannot find them, they are doing their job properly.

■ WHAT YOU NEED

your word jar, this book, a pencil, and a partner

BEGINNING**MIDDLE****END**

YOUR STORY STARTS HERE AND CARRIES ON IN YOUR BOOK

★ **BETO'S CHALLENGE**

Write your version so that the jar is never once described. The reader has to work out what is in it from what people do and say about it. This is much harder than it sounds, and it is how most good stories handle the important thing.

END OF UNIT 8

What you can do now

☐ CHECK WHAT YOU CAN DO

- 1 Write the comparing form of *faint* for two things.
- 2 Join with *but*: *It was dusty. It was beautiful.*
- 3 Write one question starting with *why*.
- 4 Name one thing a front cover tells you before you read a book.
- 5 Why is *beautifuller* wrong?
- 6 Write one adjective for *shelf* that is not *old*.

	confident	almost there	needs more work
I can predict from a cover and give my evidence	☐	☐	☐
I can read aloud in pairs and take turns properly	☐	☐	☐
I can use adjectives to compare two things and many things	☐	☐	☐
I can join two sentences with and or but	☐	☐	☐
I can write and punctuate a question	☐	☐	☐

- ✓ You can guess what a book is about before you open it, with reasons.
- ✓ You can compare two things in writing without getting the ending wrong.
- ✓ You can join sentences that belong together, and leave apart the ones that do not.
- ✓ You have written a story twice, and found out that the second time is a different story.

WORDS FROM THIS UNIT

**jar**

a glass container with a wide mouth and a lid

**star**

a huge ball of burning gas, seen as a point of light

**shelf**

a flat board fixed to a wall for putting things on

**gift**

something given to somebody without being paid

**predict**

to say what you think will happen before you know

**question**

a sentence that asks something and ends with a question mark

**connective**

a word such as and or but that joins two parts of a sentence

**cover**

the outside of a book, front and back

■ FOR TEACHERS

This unit carries 2Ri.02, 2Ri.10, 2Ri.11, 2Ri.12, 2Ri.15, 2Ra.01, 2Ra.02, 2Rw.03, 2Rg.02, 2Rg.03, 2Rg.05, 2Wg.01, 2Wg.05, 2Wg.06, 2Wg.10, 2Wv.02, 2Wv.04, 2Wv.05, 2Ws.01, 2Wc.01, 2Wc.02, 2Wc.03, 2Wp.05, 2SLp.01 and 2SLg.04.

The prediction is built to be REVISITED, not just made: page 87 asks for it, page 88 stops the story and asks again, and page 89 sends pupils back to what they wrote. A prediction nobody returns to teaches nothing, and this book's build gate E7 enforces that across the whole book.

This is the unit that spends the word jar. Pupils who have been collecting since Getting set up will have eighty or more slips and the project works beautifully; a class that has not started one should spend a lesson building slips from Units 1 to 7 first.

Misconceptions this unit tackles head on: that *-est* works when comparing two things, that long adjectives take *-er*, and that you may swap readers in the middle of a sentence.



UNIT NINE

People who help us

The last unit. Real information about firefighters, a map and an index to use, and then you make a book of your own.

OPEN THE WORKSHOP

This is the last unit in the book, and it uses almost everything in it. There is a long information text to read, a map and an index to find things in, and then you make a book of your own.

✓ BY THE END OF THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- read a long information text and find facts in it
- find a place on a map and describe where it is
- match words that mean nearly the same thing
- use an index properly to find a page
- plan and make a book of your own, with a contents page
- write a job advertisement, and design a new piece of equipment

**WARM UP
YOUR
WORDS**

Name somebody whose job is helping other people. Now name another one that nobody has said yet. Keep going round until the class runs out.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 2 you learnt to skim for a fact. You are going to need it again on the next page. What do you look for first?

**What a fire service really advises**

for teachers and families

london-fire.gov.uk/safety



The drill: everybody out, nobody running



Back at the station, checking the hose

The people who come when you call

INFORMATION TEXT · EMERGENCY NUMBER CORRECT FOR PORTUGAL

1 What the job really is. Most people think a firefighter spends the day putting out fires. In fact a modern fire and rescue service is called out to far more than fires: to road accidents, to floods, to people trapped in lifts and machinery, and to animals stuck where they should not be. Fires are the part everybody knows about, and they are only part of the work.

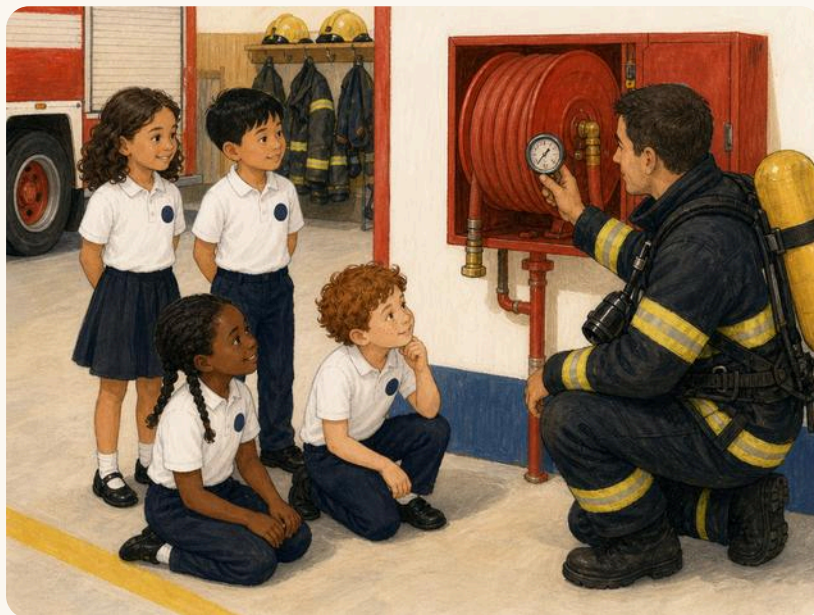
2 Before the call comes. A great deal of the job happens when nothing is happening. Equipment is checked every single shift, because a hose that fails at a fire fails at the worst possible moment. Firefighters train constantly, they walk round buildings in their area so they already know the way in, and they visit schools, because a fire that never starts is better than one that is put out.

3 What they wear, and why. The heavy coat and trousers are not just thick: they are made in layers, with an outer layer that resists flame and an inner layer that keeps steam away from the skin. The helmet has a visor. The boots have a steel plate in the sole, because the floor of a burnt building is full of nails. Breathing apparatus lets a firefighter go into smoke, and smoke, not flame, is what makes a fire so dangerous.

The people who come when you call *continued*

Working as one team. Nobody at an incident works alone. One firefighter operates the pump, others take the hose in, another keeps a written record of who has entered the building and when they went in, so that everybody is accounted for. The officer in charge stands back deliberately, because somebody has to be able to see the whole thing.

If you ever need them. In Portugal you dial 112. Say where you are first, not what has happened, because if the call is cut off the one thing they must have is the address. Then say what has happened, and how many people are there. Stay on the line until you are told you may hang up.



Checking the pressure gauge, on a shift when nothing has happened yet

Finding the facts

SUBHEADINGS

A **subheading** is a small heading inside a text that tells you what the next part is about. Subheadings are how you find the right paragraph without reading all of them, and a good non-fiction writer puts them in for exactly that reason.

WATCH TOMAS TRY 10

Beto has to find out why firefighters visit schools. Where does he look?

- 1 He does not start reading at paragraph 1. He reads the five subheadings only.
- 2 **Before the call comes** is the one about what happens when nothing is happening, so he goes there.
- 3 He finds it in the last sentence of that paragraph: a fire that never starts is better than one that is put out.
- 4 Total reading: five subheadings and one paragraph.

We found out: subheadings took Beto to the answer without reading four fifths of the text.

- 1 Use the subheadings. In which paragraph would you find what the boots are like?

2 Name three things a fire service is called out to that are not fires.

3 Why is there a steel plate in the sole of the boot?

4 What is the first thing you say when you dial 112? Why that first?

5 One firefighter writes down who has gone into the building. Why does that matter?

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

The text says smoke is more dangerous than flame. Find the sentence and say how it tells you.

9.2

Diagrams, maps and indexes

A LABELLED DIAGRAM

A **diagram** is a drawing that shows how something is put together. A **label** names one part of it. A diagram with labels can say in one picture what a paragraph needs fifty words for.



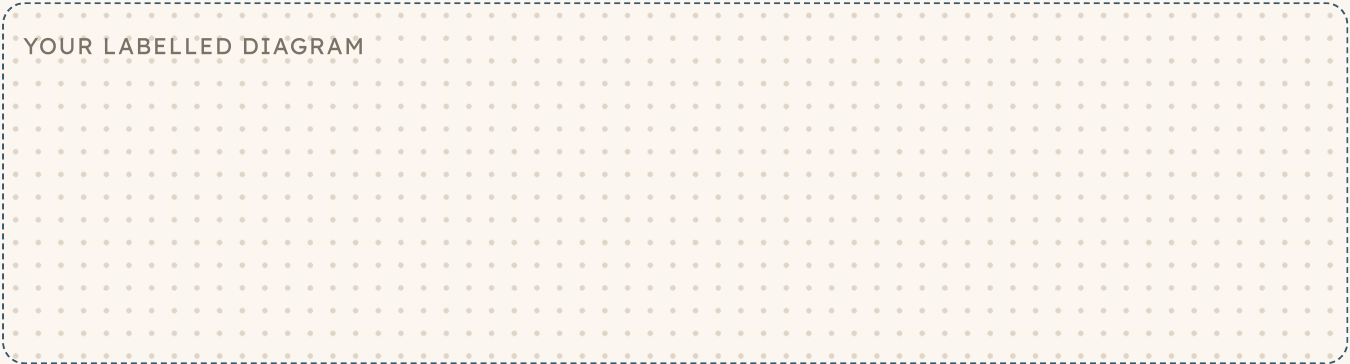
- 1 **The ladder** carried on the roof, and it extends
- 2 **The hose reel** a short hose, ready before the main one is run out
- 3 **The blue light** so drivers hear it late but see it early
- 4 **The water tank** enough to start with, before the hydrant is connected

A fire engine, with four of its parts labelled

- 6 Which labelled part is used first when the engine arrives? Say why.

- 7 Draw and label a bicycle. Use four labels.

YOUR LABELLED DIAGRAM



HOW DO YOU KNOW?

A diagram of a fire engine has no sentences in it at all. How does it still tell you something?

Using an index

■ AN INDEX

An **index** is at the BACK of a book. It lists things in **alphabetical order** with the page each one is on, so you can find one fact without reading the book. A **contents page** is at the front and lists the parts in the order they come.

Index of a short book about the fire service

boots	9
breathing apparatus	11
floods	4
helmet	10
hose	6
ladder	7
pump	6
schools, visits to	14
smoke	11
training	13

8 Use the index. Which page tells you about the helmet?

9 Two things are on page 6. Write both of them.

10 Where would *gloves* go in this index? Write the entry above it and below it.

11 Which finds chapter 3 faster: the index or the contents page?

● INES FOUND THIS OUT

Fire engines in Portugal and most of Europe carry the number 112, which works in every country in the European Union from any phone, even one with no credit and no SIM card in it at all.

9.3

Words that mean nearly the same

■ CHOOSING BETWEEN CLOSE WORDS

Some words mean nearly the same thing, but not quite. A writer chooses between them on purpose, and that choice is most of what makes writing good.

Brave, bold and fearless are close. Brave means doing it although you are afraid. Fearless means not being afraid at all. They are not the same, and a firefighter would tell you which one is true.

12 Match each word on the left with the one closest to it.

quick

broken

huge

fast

shout

enormous

damaged

yell

13 Which is the better word here, and why? *The firefighter was brave or fearless?*

- 14 Write two words that mean nearly the same as *help*.

firefighter

calm

trained

steady

WORK TOGETHER

Work in pairs. One of you says an ordinary word. The other has to say a closer, more exact word for it. Then swap. Keep the good ones on your word slips.

WHAT YOU NEED

your word slips, a pencil, and a partner

HOW DO YOU KNOW?

Yell and *shout* are very close. Say one thing that is different about them.

FINAL PROJECT

EVERYTHING IN THIS WHOLE BOOK

★ MAKE YOUR OWN BOOK

Make **a book of your own** about people who help us. This is the last project in this book and it uses everything in it.

- 1 Choose four jobs. Not four you like: four that are genuinely different from each other.
- 2 One page each. Give every page a subheading, three true sentences and a labelled diagram.
- 3 Find your facts by asking somebody who knows, or from a book. Write down where each fact came from.
- 4 Make a contents page for the front, in the order your pages come.
- 5 Make an index for the back, in alphabetical order, with the page numbers.
- 6 Write a job advertisement for one of your four jobs: what the job is, what you need to be good at, and one honest hard part.

■ WHAT YOU NEED

four sheets of paper folded into a booklet, a pencil, coloured pencils, and somebody to ask about a job

Your contents page

Page 1
Page 2
Page 3
Page 4

★ BETO'S CHALLENGE

Design a new piece of equipment a fire service does not have yet. Draw it, label four parts, and write two sentences saying what problem it solves. Then write the one sentence an inventor always has to write: what could go wrong with it.

END OF UNIT 9

What you can do now

☐ CHECK WHAT YOU CAN DO

- 1 Say where you would find an index, and where a contents page is.
- 2 Write a word that means nearly the same as *enormous*.
- 3 What is the first thing you say when you call for help?
- 4 Name two things a fire service does that are not fires.
- 5 What does a subheading do for a reader?
- 6 Which is closer to *brave*: *afraid* or *bold*?

	confident	almost there	needs more work
I can find a fact in a long text using the subheadings	☐	☐	☐
I can read a labelled diagram and make one	☐	☐	☐
I can use an index and a contents page for the right job	☐	☐	☐
I can choose between two words that are close in meaning	☐	☐	☐
I can plan and make a book with a contents page and an index	☐	☐	☐

- ✓ You can get a fact out of a long text without reading all of it.
- ✓ You can find anything in a book, from either end of it.
- ✓ You can choose the exact word instead of the first word.
- ✓ You have made a book with a contents page and an index in it, which means you now know how every non-fiction book you pick up was built.

WORDS FROM THIS UNIT

**fire engine**

the vehicle a fire crew and their equipment travel in

**hose**

a long flexible tube that carries water

**ladder**

steps you climb, carried on the engine

**ambulance**

a vehicle that takes ill or hurt people to hospital

**map**

a drawing of a place seen from above

**uniform**

the special clothing worn for a job

**index**

an alphabetical list at the back of a book with page numbers

**subheading**

a small heading inside a text saying what the next part is about

■ FOR TEACHERS

This unit carries 2Ri.04, 2Ri.05, 2Ri.06, 2Ri.09, 2Ri.13, 2Ri.14, 2Ri.15, 2Rs.03, 2Rv.01, 2Rv.02, 2Rv.03, 2Ra.01, 2Ws.02, 2Ws.03, 2Wc.04, 2Wc.05, 2Wv.04, 2Wv.05, 2Wp.03, 2Wp.04 and 2SLm.03.

The information text is deliberately about what the job is NOT, because almost every pupil arrives certain that firefighters put out fires all day. Starting from a correction is what makes the text worth reading rather than confirming.

The emergency number given is 112, correct for Portugal and the whole European Union. A school outside the EU should change it before teaching page 105, and this is the one fact in the book that a teacher must localise.

The final project is the assessment for the whole book: a pupil who can produce four sourced pages with subheadings, diagrams, a contents page and an index has demonstrated most of the Stage 2 writing and reading objectives at once. It is worth three lessons, not one.

WORD LIST

Every word in this book

In alphabetical order, with the unit each word was taught in. Use the alphabet strip on page 79 if you need it.

A

adjective

A word that tells you more about a noun. In *a wonky kite*, the adjective is *wonky*. *Unit 1.*

alphabetical order

The order of the alphabet, using the first letter of each word. Glossaries and indexes are arranged this way. *Unit 7.*

ambulance

A vehicle that takes ill or hurt people to hospital. *Unit 9.*

athlete

Somebody who competes in a sport. *Unit 2.*

C

carrot

A long orange root vegetable. *Unit 3.*

character

A person or animal in a story. *Unit 1.*

comma

The mark that separates things in a list, or separates parts of a sentence. It never ends a sentence. *Unit 2.*

command

A sentence that tells somebody to do something. It starts with the doing word: *Chop the onion*. *Unit 3.*

compound word

One word made by joining two whole words together, such as *playground*. *Unit 1.*

connective

A word such as *and*, *but*, *because*, *if* or *when* that joins two parts of a sentence. *Unit 8.*

contents page

A list at the front of a book showing its parts in the order they come, with page numbers. *Unit 6.*

cover

The outside of a book, front and back. It tells you a good deal before you open it. *Unit 8.*

D

diagram

A drawing that shows how something is put together, usually with labels naming its parts. *Unit 9.*

diary

A book you write in about what happened to you, usually with the date at the top of each entry. *Unit 4.*

WORD LIST · CONTINUED

D**dolphin**

A sea mammal that breathes air, lives in a group and finds food using sound. *Unit 5.*

dream

The pictures and stories in your head while you are asleep. *Unit 7.*

F**fable**

A short story, often with animals in it, that is told in order to teach a lesson. *Unit 5.*

fiction

Writing that somebody made up. *Unit 2.*

fire engine

The vehicle a fire crew and their equipment travel in. *Unit 9.*

football

A ball game played with the feet. *Unit 1.*

full stop

The mark that ends a statement or a command. *Unit 1.*

G**gift**

Something given to somebody without being paid for it. *Unit 8.*

gull

A large seabird with grey and white feathers. *Unit 5.*

H**helmet**

A hard hat that protects the head. *Unit 6.*

hose

A long flexible tube that carries water. *Unit 9.*

hurdle

A barrier that a runner jumps over. *Unit 2.*

I**index**

An alphabetical list at the back of a book, with the page number for each thing in it. *Unit 9.*

J**jar**

A glass container with a wide mouth and a lid. *Unit 8.*

WORD LIST · CONTINUED

J**javelin**

A long light spear that is thrown in athletics. *Unit 2.*

jellyfish

A soft, almost see-through sea animal that can sting. *Unit 6.*

juggle

To keep several things in the air at once by throwing and catching them. *Unit 1.*

K**kite**

A light frame covered in paper or cloth, flown on a string in the wind. *Unit 1.*

L**ladder**

Steps you climb, carried on a fire engine and made to extend. *Unit 9.*

life ring

A ring that floats, thrown to somebody in the water. It is thrown, never swum out with. *Unit 6.*

lighthouse

A tower with a light in it, warning ships away from rocks. *Unit 5.*

M**map**

A drawing of a place as it would look from above. *Unit 9.*

market

A place where food and other goods are sold, often outdoors. *Unit 3.*

medal

A metal disc given to somebody for winning or achieving something. *Unit 2.*

moon

The large round light in the night sky. It has no light of its own: it reflects the sun's. *Unit 7.*

N**neighbour**

Somebody who lives near you. *Unit 4.*

non-fiction

Writing about things that are really true. *Unit 2.*

noun

A naming word, such as *kite*, *sister* or *hill*. *Unit 1.*

WORD LIST · CONTINUED

O**ocean**

One of the very large areas of salt water that cover most of the Earth. *Unit 5.*

owl

A bird that hunts at night and flies almost silently. *Unit 7.*

P**pencil**

A thin stick of wood with a grey core, for writing and drawing. *Unit 4.*

pillow

The soft cushion you rest your head on in bed. *Unit 7.*

playground

An outdoor place made for playing in. *Unit 1.*

playscript

Writing set out to be acted, with the speaker's name on the left and no speech marks. *Unit 3.*

plural

The form of a word that means more than one. Some plurals change the word: *mouse* becomes *mice*. *Unit 5.*

poem

Writing in short lines, often with a pattern of sound or rhythm. *Unit 3.*

predict

To say what you think will happen before you know. *Unit 8.*

promise

Something you say you will definitely do. *Unit 5.*

Q**question**

A sentence that asks something. It ends with a question mark. *Unit 8.*

question mark

The mark that ends a question. *Unit 1.*

R**rain**

Water falling from clouds. *Unit 4.*

recipe

Written instructions for cooking something. *Unit 3.*

WORD LIST · CONTINUED

R**report**

Writing that tells a reader plainly and truthfully what happened. *Unit 2.*

rhyme

When two words end with the same sound, such as *rain* and *chain*. *Unit 3.*

riverbank

The land at the edge of a river. *Unit 6.*

root word

The word that a longer word is built on. The root of *sleepy* is *sleep*. *Unit 7.*

S**sentence**

A group of words that makes sense on its own. It begins with a capital letter and ends with a full stop, a question mark or an exclamation mark. *Unit 1.*

setting

The place where a story happens. *Unit 1.*

shelf

A flat board fixed to a wall for putting things on. *Unit 8.*

shore

The land along the edge of the sea. *Unit 5.*

soup

A hot liquid food made by cooking things in water. *Unit 3.*

speech marks

The marks that hold the exact words somebody says, and nothing else. *Unit 1.*

spoon

A tool with a shallow bowl on a handle, for eating with. *Unit 3.*

star

A huge ball of burning gas, seen from Earth as a point of light. *Unit 8.*

stopwatch

A watch that times exactly how long something takes. *Unit 2.*

string

Thin cord that you tie or pull with. *Unit 1.*

WORD LIST · CONTINUED

S**subheading**

A small heading inside a text, saying what the next part is about. *Unit 9.*

suffix

An ending added to a word to make a new word, such as *-ly* or *-ful*. *Unit 7.*

syllable

A beat in a word. You can hear them by clapping as you say it. *Unit 1.*

T**tag**

A small label tied to something, so that whoever finds it knows what it is for. *Unit 4.*

thank you

What you say to somebody who has helped you. *Unit 4.*

torch

A small lamp you hold in your hand. *Unit 7.*

track

The marked path that runners race along. *Unit 2.*

U**umbrella**

A folding cover on a stick that keeps the rain off you. *Unit 4.*

uniform

The special clothing worn for a job or by a school. *Unit 9.*

V**verb**

A doing or being word, such as *ran*, *made* or *is*. *Unit 4.*

W**warning**

Something that tells you about a danger before you meet it. *Unit 6.*

wind

Air moving from one place to another. *Unit 1.*



Free books to read at home

for families

oxfordowl.co.uk

WHERE THE FACTS CAME FROM

Every fact in this book has an address

The stories and poems in this book were invented. The facts were not. Everything the book states as true was checked against one of the sources below while it was being written, and each one of these pages answered when we went to look.

Figures that change, such as the number of athletes at a Games or the number of dolphins in a sea, are dated where they appear in the text. When they change, the QR codes in those units are where the new numbers will be.

- **Unit 2** · Paralympic Games history, athlete and country numbers for Rome 1960, Seoul 1988, Sydney 2000, London 2012 and Paris 2024, and the meaning of the Agitos symbol
International Paralympic Committee, paralympic.org
- **Unit 2** · The 1948 Stoke Mandeville archery competition, and Ludwig Guttman
International Paralympic Committee history pages, paralympic.org
- **Unit 5** · Bottlenose dolphins: breathing through a blowhole, echolocation, living in pods, and resting one half of the brain at a time
Whale and Dolphin Conservation, uk.whales.org
- **Unit 6** · Water safety: swimming where there is a lifeguard, the effect of cold water on the muscles, floating on your back to control your breathing, and throwing rather than carrying a life ring
Royal National Lifeboat Institution, rnli.org/safety
- **Unit 7** · How much sleep a child of six or seven needs
National Health Service, nhs.uk, sleep and tiredness
- **Unit 7** · Why an owl flies almost silently: the fringed leading edge of the wing feathers
Natural History Museum, nhm.ac.uk
- **Unit 9** · What a fire and rescue service is called out to, protective clothing in layers, breathing apparatus, and the entry record kept at an incident
London Fire Brigade, london-fire.gov.uk/safety
- **Unit 9** · 112 as the emergency number across the European Union, working from any phone
European Commission, ec.europa.eu
- **Unit 1** · The age of the earliest known kites, and the red kite the toy is named after
Natural History Museum, nhm.ac.uk
- **Unit 8** · Roughly how many stars are visible to the unaided eye on a dark night
Royal Observatory Greenwich, rmg.co.uk
- **Curriculum** · The 99 Stage 2 learning objectives this book is written to support

WHERE THE FACTS CAME FROM · CONTINUED



Stories and poems to listen to
etc.usf.edu/lit2go



The curriculum behind this book

FOR TEACHERS

How this book maps to Stage 2

Sub-strand	Code	Units that carry it
Reading: word structure and phonics	2Rw	1, 4, 6, 7, 8
Reading: vocabulary and language	2Rv	1, 3, 5, 6, 7, 9
Reading: grammar and punctuation	2Rg	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 8
Reading: structure of texts	2Rs	1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 9
Reading: interpretation of texts	2Ri	all nine units
Reading: appreciation and reflection	2Ra	1, 2, 3, 5, 7, 8, 9
Writing: spelling	2Ww	1, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7
Writing: vocabulary and language	2Wv	1, 2, 4, 5, 8, 9
Writing: grammar and punctuation	2Wg	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8
Writing: structure of texts	2Ws	1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 9
Writing: creation of texts	2Wc	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 9
Writing: presentation and reflection	2Wp	1, 2, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9
Speaking: making yourself understood	2SLm	1, 3, 5, 6, 7, 9
Speaking: showing understanding	2SLs	4, 6, 7
Speaking: group work and discussion	2SLg	1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 8
Speaking: performance	2SLp	1, 3, 5, 7, 8
Speaking: reflection and evaluation	2SLr	every unit closer

FOR TEACHERS · CONTINUED

■ FOR TEACHERS

Every page in this book declares the objectives it carries, and the build refuses to produce a PDF if a page claims an objective that is not in the published Stage 2 framework, or if any sub-strand falls below a minimum number of objectives. The table above is generated from those declarations rather than written by hand.

This book does not claim to cover all 99 Stage 2 objectives. The framework is written for a whole year of teaching across many resources, and a single student book that claimed all of it would be making a false claim rather than a strong one. What it does claim is that every sub-strand is genuinely served, and the unit closers tell you which.

The nine units are in a deliberate order. Units 1, 4, 5, 7 and 8 are narrative, Units 2, 6 and 9 are non-fiction, and Unit 3 is drama and poetry, so a term never runs on one text type. Each unit takes about three and a half weeks at four to five hours a week.

Two things run right through the book and are worth protecting: the word slips begun in Getting set up, which Unit 8's project spends, and the habit of reading aloud before writing, which every modelled attempt in the book relies on.

**The curriculum behind this book**

for teachers

PRIME BOOKS

English

□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

Four pupils, one notebook, and every word earned.

You will meet four pupils in these pages, each with a different way into writing.
s before you try it, then try the awkward question, which is usually

INSIDE THIS BOOK

- Reading, writing, speaking and listening together
- Four young writers to learn alongside
- Every new word met, used and kept
- A story and a poem in every unit
- Original watercolour illustration throughout

Prime Books • English

Ages 6–7 • Lower Primary

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